

## NDA leaders to gather in Varanasi for PM's birthday

OUR CORRESPONDENT  
New Delhi, September 16

NDA leaders including Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu, Maharashtra Deputy Chief Minister Eknath Shinde, Defence Minister Rajnath Singh, Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath and Union minister Chirag Paswan will gather in Prime Minister Narendra Modi's Lok Sabha constituency Varanasi on Thursday to mark his 76th birthday and 25 years

CONTINUED ON P4

## NO FOREIGN INFLUENCE, SAYS CENTRE

# Govt, Oppn clash over new UPI charges

No question of rolling back UPI charges, says govt as Opposition demands reversal

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, September 16

The Opposition on Wednesday stepped up its attack on the government over UPI transaction charges, demanding an immediate rollback, even as the government made it clear there was no question of reversing the decision.

The Centre rejected claims that the introduction of a Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) on UPI payments was driven by foreign influence, after the opposition alleged that the move was aimed



at appeasing US President Donald Trump.

Clearing the air over the allegations, the Finance Ministry said India's UPI

policy decisions were made "independently", and it would continue to remain free for consumers.

CONTINUED ON P4

## UPI MDR may attract 18% GST

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, September 16

Merchants will have to pay 18 per cent GST on the Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) charged for UPI payments above Rs 2,000 from October 15, although GST-registered businesses can claim Input Tax Credit (ITC) on the tax paid, tax experts said on Wednesday.

CONTINUED ON P4

## India summons Pakistan envoy over Pak vessel-Indian warship collision

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE  
New Delhi, September 16

India on Wednesday summoned Pakistan's Charge d'Affaires Saad Warraich and lodged a strong diplomatic protest over what it called "unacceptable and unprofessional" conduct by a Pakistani Navy vessel that resulted in a collision with a frontline Indian Navy warship in the North Arabian Sea. The incident took place in international waters on the evening of September 15 while the Indian vessel was carrying out a routine surveillance mission.

CONTINUED ON P4

## India condemns drone attack near Makkah

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 16

India on Wednesday expressed deep concern over a Houthis drone attack near Makkah in Saudi Arabia and called for an early return of peace and stability in West Asia. Saudi authorities said air defences intercepted and

CONTINUED ON P4

## 'No legal basis': India rejects 'so-called' Pak-China Boundary Joint Commission

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 16

India on Wednesday rejected the "so-called" Pakistan-China Boundary Joint Commission, saying it has no legal basis to deal with Indian territories under occupation. The reaction followed the commission's first meeting in Islamabad. External Affairs Ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said India has never recognised the 1963 China-Pakistan Boundary Agreement, under which Pakistan handed over the Shaksgam Valley to China.

SEE P4

## Govt raises EPF wage ceiling to Rs 25,000

To benefit over 51 lakh employees

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 16

The Union Cabinet on Wednesday approved raising the wage ceiling for mandatory coverage under the Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO) from Rs 15,000 to Rs 25,000 per month, a move that will bring more workers under the formal social security system.

The revision, the first in 12 years, will take effect from 'Vishwakarma Day' on September 17, 2026. Information and Broadcasting Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said the decision is expected to bring more than 51 lakh additional employees under manda-

tory EPFO coverage. "Rs 25,000 per month salary will be the new ceiling for provident fund deduction," he said at a press briefing.

The Ministry of Labour and Employment said the higher ceiling will expand access to provident fund savings, pension benefits under the Employees' Pension Scheme (EPS) and insurance protection through the Employees' Deposit Linked Insurance Scheme (EDLI), subject to applicable scheme provisions.

The EPFO wage ceiling had remained unchanged from 2004 to 2014 before being raised to Rs 15,000 in September 2014.

CONTINUED ON P4

## Lifetime free rail travel for Sena, Nau Sena, Vayu Sena Medal recipients

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE  
New Delhi, September 16

The Centre has extended lifetime free rail travel to Armed Forces personnel who receive the gallantry category of the Sena Medal, Nau Sena Medal and Vayu Sena Medal, along with eligible family members and one companion. The three service medals will now be covered under the railway travel concession already available to recipients of the six major 'Chakra' gallantry awards.

CONTINUED ON P4

## Actor Anant Nag to receive Dadasaheb Phalke Award

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, September 16

Veteran actor Anant Nag will receive the Dadasaheb Phalke Award for 2024 for his contribution to Indian cinema, the government announced on Wednesday. The 78-year-old actor, who has worked in more than 250 films over five decades, is known for his work in Kannada and Hindi cinema as well as theatre. The award, the highest recognition in Indian



CONTINUED ON P4

## Fertility falls to 1.9, EAC-PM seeks policy shift

End sterilisation-linked incentive payments, roll back population control rules: EAC-PM

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, September 16

The Economic Advisory Council to the Prime Minister (EAC-PM) has recommended withdrawing sterilisation-linked incentive payments and other population-control measures, citing India's declining fertility rate and changing demographic profile.

In its working paper, titled The Ghost of Population Past: How Population Control Persists in India, the EAC-PM said India's total fertility rate (TFR) has fallen to 1.9, below the replacement level. Excluding Bihar and Uttar Pradesh, the TFR is 1.6,

comparable with Northern Europe at 1.5 and the United States at 1.6.

The council called for an end to direct benefit transfers linked to sterilisation, including acceptor payments, wage-loss compensation and enhanced incentives for acceptors and service providers. It said there was "no economic rationale" for continuing such payments in states where fertility is already below replacement levels.

The paper also recommended ending motivational incentives linked to terminal family-planning methods, as well as ASHA incentives associated with limiting

CONTINUED ON P4

Ministry of Culture  
Government of India

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# Satya Niketan collapse not ordinary mishap: Delhi HC

Court says students came to Delhi with hopes and dreams

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 16

The Delhi High Court on Wednesday said the multi-storey hostel building collapse in Satya Niketan, which resulted in the death of seven persons including students, was not an ordinary mishap.

A bench of Chief Justice D K Upadhyaya and Justice Tejas Karia said the four students who died came to the nation's capital from small towns with hopes of building a career, but these were "shattered" due to the "callous and criminal conduct" of certain persons.

"Four students lost their lives in the mishap...very tragic. It's not an ordinary incident of any mishap. These four students had come to the capital with a lot of hopes and dreams, coming from small towns. All of that was shattered by such callous and criminal conduct on the part of (certain persons)," the court orally remarked.

The building at Satya Niketan, which housed a boys' paying-guest accommodation near the Delhi University's South Campus, collapsed on September 6 while repair work was underway. Several people were also injured in the collapse.



## 'CRIMINAL CONDUCT'

- » The building at Satya Niketan, which housed a boys' paying-guest accommodation near the Delhi University's South Campus, collapsed on September 6 while repair work was underway. Several people were also injured in the collapse
- » Additional Solicitor General Chetan Sharma said that several steps have been taken by the authorities after the incident, including proactive mapping and earmarking of land...

was underway. Several people were also injured in the collapse.

Additional Solicitor General Chetan Sharma said that several steps have been taken by the authorities after the incident, including proactive

mapping and earmarking of land and other facilities for students.

The bench, however, responded that the issue of lack of hostel facilities was not a "new phenomenon".

"Who doesn't know the problem of hostels in the

city? Students are flocking to Delhi for higher education, and this is not a new phenomenon. It has been happening for the last 20-25 years in the hope that they will build their career. See what has happened," the bench remarked.

The court was hearing a PIL by Aakarshak Danveer Rathi which sought an independent probe into the matter, inspection of all paying guests as well as compensation and rehabilitation scheme for victims and families.

The court said the PIL would be heard along with another pending petition on September 25.

The high court on September 7 ordered a high-level MCD inquiry into the incident and made it clear that the government cannot evade responsibility.

It had said the incident is not only unfortunate but it has evoked deep concern about inadequate housing facilities, including hostels run by Delhi University or the government, safety and security of students and not-so-adequate measures employed by the MCD and other authorities to regulate such PG facilities.

## Hit-&run: Bainsla, cousin sent to two days' police remand

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Gurugram, September 16

Gurugram hit-and-run accused Kalyan Bainsla and his cousin Lovneesh were sent to two days' police remand by a city court on Wednesday, an official said. The police sought custody to recreate the crime scene. The next hearing has been scheduled for September 18.

Gurugram Police Commissioner Sibash Kabiraj also formed a special investigation team (SIT), headed by ACP (Crime Against Women) Sushila Devi, to probe the case.

Bainsla, a gym owner, allegedly hit biker Shivani Chauhan, alias Siya, with his car on Golf Course Road on Sunday, knocking her off the motorcycle and leaving her injured. Police later booked him under an attempt-to-murder charge after examining Instagram videos and CCTV footage.

Bainsla and Lovneesh were arrested from Rajgarh in Rajasthan on Tuesday. Police said Bainsla had earlier switched off his phone and absconded after speaking to the media.

Chauhan joined the investigation after the arrest and alleged that an attempt was made on her life. Based on her complaint, police added charges under Sections 109, 78 and 79 of the BNS to the FIR.

# Refusal to lend a matchbox to light cigarette ends in murder

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 16

A seemingly trivial refusal to lend a matchbox to light a cigarette escalated into a fatal quarrel and stabbing in northwest Delhi, leaving a 30-year-old construction worker dead and another man injured, police said on Wednesday.

The incident took place on Tuesday in front of a wine shop in the Keshav Puram area when the victims, Bhawani and Asha Ram, allegedly got into an argument with three people after they were asked for a matchbox to light a cigarette, they said.

According to police, the victims told the accused that they did not have a matchbox, following which a verbal spat broke out. The accused allegedly attacked the two men with



fists and a knife during the heated exchange, a senior police officer said.

Bhawani was rushed to Deep Chand Bandhu Hospital, where he was declared brought dead. He had sustained a deep stab wound on the left side of his back, the officer said.

Asha Ram, 32, suffered a stab injury to his left lower chest and was undergoing treatment. He was declared unfit to give a statement, police said.

The deceased's brother Ramcharan said he learnt about the attack after receiving a call from Asha Ram and immediately

rushed to the hospital.

"I got a call from Asha Ram that both of the people had been stabbed. I had gone to Dwarka at that time but rushed to the hospital. My brother died in the hospital," Ramcharan said.

"He was on his way when someone asked for a bidi. Upon refusing, he was stabbed with a knife," he alleged.

Ramcharan said his brother was a construction worker and a native of Amethi in Uttar Pradesh. He lived alone in Delhi for work, while his wife and three children stayed back in Amethi.

Police arrested three accused, including a juvenile, in the murder case registered at Keshav Puram police station, and recovered the weapon allegedly used in the stabbing.

## MCD eyes decentralised waste treatment

New Delhi, September 16

The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) will prepare ward-wise sanitation action plans and reduce the city's dependence on conventional community bins as part of efforts to strengthen solid waste management, MCD Commissioner Sanjeev Khirwar said on Wednesday.

Khirwar directed Zonal Deputy Commissioners to assess sanitation arrangements in every ward and identify facilities within 5-6 km for decentral-

ised treatment of biodegradable waste through biogas, compressed biogas, composting and other technologies.

Different waste collection models will be adopted for residential societies, unauthorised colonies, congested streets, slums, hospitals, markets and institutional areas.

MCD will deploy smaller vehicles in narrow lanes, reduce community bins, make markets bin-free and expand night sweeping, mechanised cleaning and zero-waste colonies.

MPOST

# DUSU polls: Over 2,000 personnel to guard DU

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 16

Security arrangements have been stepped up across Delhi University ahead of student union elections, with more than 2,000 personnel, including paramilitary forces, to be deployed during campaigning, polling and counting, a police officer said on Wednesday.

The final day of campaigning is Wednesday, while polling will be held on Friday and results for the Delhi University Students' Union (DUSU) election declared on Saturday.

The officer said security would be heightened around colleges and locations to ensure peaceful elections and maintain law and order. Police will be deployed at strategic points, while foot patrols, motorcycle teams and PCR vans will maintain a presence.



ence. The deployment will focus on preventing clashes, unauthorised gatherings and untoward incidents. Police teams will monitor sensitive points, areas with heavy movement. Arrangements will be made near polling centres to regulate movement and prevent overcrowding.

Police are coordinating with college authorities on entry/exit points and arrangements for polling and counting. Personnel will be deployed during counting on Saturday.

Meanwhile, Delhi University Vice Chancellor

Yogesh Singh directed college principals and officials to ensure fair, transparent and peaceful conduct of the DUSU elections during a meeting with university and Delhi Police officials on Wednesday.

Principals were asked to maintain heightened security for three to four days and appoint teachers as police liaisons. EVMs will be delivered to colleges a day before polling, with voting scheduled from 8.30 am to 1 pm for day classes and 3 pm to 7.30 pm for evening classes. Night patrols will continue

## CHIB SAID STUDENTS SHOULD NOT BE FORCED TO SPEND MAJOR PORTION OF THEIR FAMILY INCOME ON PVT ACCOMMODATION...

until September 18, while women constables will be deployed at women's colleges on polling day.

NSUI, ABVP spar over govt's 10,000 student hostel announcement

The NSUI sought a transparent, time-bound plan from the Delhi government on the proposed hostels for 10,000 students, asking for details on their implementation.

NSUI national president Vinod Jakhar said the organisation was not opposed to the proposal but wanted clarity on its

execution. ABVP Delhi state secretary Sarthak Sharma accused the NSUI of politicising the accommodation issue, saying his organisation had consistently demanded increased hostel capacity. He also questioned the Congress' record on student accommodation.

Separately, the Indian Youth Congress held a march at Delhi University, with its national president Uday Bhanu Chib demanding safer and affordable accommodation, particularly for students from outside Delhi and economically weaker families.

Chib said students should not be forced to spend a major portion of their family income on private accommodation and urged the government and university administration to focus on delivering hostel facilities rather than making announcements.

## HOSTEL FAN COLLAPSE

## JNU students flag ageing hostel infra

ANAMTA FATIMA

New Delhi, September 16

A ceiling fan collapsing inside a room at Jawaharlal Nehru University's Tapti Hostel has once again raised questions over the safety and maintenance of student accommodation on the campus.

The incident took place in the night, when a ceiling fan fell inside a hostel room. No student was present at the time, according to the Jawaharlal Nehru University Students' Union (JNUSU), which raised the issue in a statement on Wednesday.

The students' union alleged that the incident reflected a larger problem of inadequate maintenance of JNU's ageing infrastructure. It said that during a meeting with the

JNUSU, the former Associate Dean of Students had stated that Tapti and Mahi Mandavi hostels had been declared unfit for accommodation. Despite this, students continued to be allotted rooms in the hostels, the union alleged.

The JNUSU said the problem extended beyond the two hostels, with students reporting leaking ceilings, crumbling walls and deteriorating infrastructure in classrooms and other parts of the campus.

JNUSU flagged poor maintenance at Teflas and sought a structural audit of hostels and university buildings, citing repeated complaints and long-standing infrastructure concerns raised through protests, petitions and hunger strikes.

## Bank manager

## among 5 arrested in Rs 12.84-crore NBFC fraud

Chinese links found

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 16

Delhi Police has busted a cybercrime racket allegedly involved in siphoning off Rs 12.84 crore from an NBFC's account through 317 unauthorised digital transactions, with five people, including a bank relationship manager, arrested, officials said on Wednesday.

The investigation found alleged links to Chinese groups on Telegram. Part of the cheated money was converted into USDT and transferred to fraudsters abroad, police said.

The case was registered on August 21 after the NBFC detected unauthorised debits. The transactions were routed to 34 bank accounts. Police placed a lien on Rs 1.7 crore.

The arrested accused were identified as Abhay Kumar Solanki of Bulandshahr, Lovely (26) of Kurukshetra, Naman Kumar and Vikas (30) from Jaipur, and Harman (24) of Bikaner.

Police said Naman's accounts received Rs 40 lakh and Rs 70 lakh, with one linked to 43 cybercrime complaints.

Harman operated Naman's account to receive and transfer the money and remained in contact with Chinese groups. Harman received Rs 1.5 lakh from Udaipur-based Devender Singh Chauhan, who converted the money into USDT and transferred it abroad.

Vikas allegedly helped Naman open accounts and introduced him to Harman. Five mobile phones, cheque books and Property Gallery rubber stamps were seized.

## 2 students hurt in election clash

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 16

Two Satyawati College students were injured and two SUVs damaged after an altercation in north-west Delhi's Bharat Nagar area, around a kilometre from the college, while campaigning for student union elections, police said on Wednesday.

The injured, Ansh and Bhavishya Chaudhary, both 19, were taken to Deep Chand Bandhu Hospital. The incident occurred near Wazirpur village on Tuesday.

Police received information about assault and firing but have not confirmed gunfire or the motive. The SUVs were seized, while Crime Team and FSL personnel collected evidence. Police are scanning CCTV footage and questioning witnesses to establish the sequence of events.

## Poetry, music mark 6 yrs of Khalid's arrest

New Delhi, September 16

A gathering of artists and activists in Delhi on Wednesday marked six years of former JNU student Umar Khalid's jailing, with poetry, music and theatre performances.

The event 'Hum Dekhenge: An Evening of Cultural Resistance' was organised by the Association for Protection of Civil Rights (APCR) at the Press Club of India.

The evening featured resistance songs, protest poetry, 'nazms' and monologues, with performances drawing on several themes, including the anti-Citizenship Amendment Act protests, freedom of expression, and life in prison.

A dramatic recitation, 'Jail Mein Ek Din', was

## THE EVENING FEATURED RESISTANCE SONGS, PROTEST POETRY, 'NAZMS' AND MONOLOGUES...

mounted to enact a day in prison.

One of the researchers associated with the APCR, Prakriti, said the programme was meant to draw attention not only to Khalid's imprisonment but also to others facing injustice and suppression.

"It is about the right to freedom of expression and preserving space for dissent. Art, poetry, songs and other forms of cultural expression can give voice to those whose concerns often remain unheard," she said. PII

## Teenager dies after falling from 15<sup>th</sup> floor in Ghaziabad

DIPIKA KIROLA

Ghaziabad, September 16

A 16-year-old Class 10 student died after falling from the 15th floor of a residential tower in Gaur Siddhartham society in Vijay Nagar on Tuesday night. Police said a two-page note recovered from the spot referred to academic pressure.

The girl, identified as Shanaya Bisht, was rushed to a nearby hospital, where doctors declared her dead. She lived in the society with her family and studied at Indrapuram Public School.

Police said the note contained messages to her parents, younger sister and relatives. The note and handwriting are being examined, while statements of family members and residents are being recorded.

## SW DELHI'S NASIRPUR AREA

## Lawyer stabbing: Lesser charge sparks questions

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

New Delhi, September 16

A 52-year-old advocate practising in Delhi courts was allegedly stabbed in the abdomen by a relative in southwest Delhi's Nasirpur area, with questions being raised over the initial handling of the case by Delhi Police, which registered an FIR under Section 118(I) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), instead of the more serious charge of attempt to murder.

The FIR was registered at Sagarpur police station on September 14 and states that the incident took place around 8.30 pm on September

## INCIDENT OCCURED NEAR 265 DDA FLATS IN NAV JEEVAN APT

13 near 265 DDA Flats in Nav Jeevan Apartment, Nasirpur.

According to the complaint, Manjit Singh (52) told police that he had sustained a stab injury during the incident.

He was taken to Manipal Hospital, Dwarka, where a medico-legal examination found a 2 cm by 2 cm punctured wound on the upper left side of his abdomen, below the costal margin. The injury was caused by a sharp weapon,

though the nature of the weapon was kept under observation.

Police initially booked the case under Section 118(I), which deals with voluntarily causing hurt using dangerous weapons, including instruments used for shooting, stabbing or cutting.

The complainant's side, however, maintained that the incident amounted to an attempt to murder.

Following intervention by the New Delhi Bar Association, Section 109 of the BNS was added, amid allegations of police inaction and improper handling of the stabbing case.

MINISTER CALLS FOR TURNING DELHI INTO ‘SOLAR CAPITAL’ OF INDIA

Delhi to go big on rooftop solar

AIMAN FATIMA  
New Delhi, September 16

Delhi govt is preparing for a major rooftop solar push, with the government setting a target of 2.3 lakh installations in the next six months and an estimated investment of up to Rs 2,700 crore, as Power Minister Ashish Sood on Wednesday called for turning the national capital into the “Solar Capital” of India.

Addressing a meeting with solar vendors and other stakeholders, Sood called for a faster rollout of rooftop solar projects and said the government was working towards making Delhi the “Solar Capital” of the country.

“We want to make Delhi the ‘Solar Capital’ of India. Scale and Speed, on which the honourable Prime Minister of the country, Shri Narendra Modi ji, works; so we are his disciples and will try to work with him at the same speed. We will try to work as quickly as possible, work at speed, and work at scale,” Sood said.

The minister said the government was seeking



to remove some of the hurdles faced by consumers and vendors, particularly those related to upfront payments. Under the new implementation mechanism, the government will take responsibility for payments to vendors.

“Consumers also hesitate to pay upfront... So, the

government has removed the barrier between you and the consumer. We will pay the full amount. The government is taking responsibility,” he said.

The Power Department has also launched a dedicated registration portal as part of the implementation process. Sood urged

KEY POINTS

» The minister said the government was seeking to remove some of the hurdles faced by consumers and vendors, particularly those related to upfront payments

» Under the new implementation mechanism, the government will take responsibility for payments to vendors

» Consumers also hesitate to pay upfront... So, the government has removed the barrier between you and the consumer. We will pay the full amount. The government is taking responsibility: Minister

more than welcome,” he said, inviting vendors to share their feedback with his office. The government’s six-month target would require the installation of nearly 38,000 solar systems every month on average, if the proposed 2.3 lakh installations are achieved within the stated time-frame. The minister said the initiative was expected to have an impact beyond renewable energy adoption, with increased solar activity likely to generate employment opportunities and contribute to economic growth in the capital.

The government said the proposed expansion of rooftop solar capacity is part of its broader push towards cleaner energy and greater adoption of solar power among households and other consumers.

The meeting brought together solar vendors and stakeholders to discuss implementation of the scheme, with the government maintaining that faster execution and greater participation from vendors would be crucial to achieving the installation target.

READY TO RUN...



Chief Minister Rekha Gupta unveils the finisher medal for the Vedanta Delhi Half Marathon 2026 at the Delhi Secretariat on Wednesday, in the presence of Tourism Minister Kapil Mishra and other dignitaries

Diyas to yagya, Delhi govt to mark PM Modi’s birthday

OUR CORRESPONDENT  
New Delhi, September 16

The Delhi government will organise four programmes centred on service and public participation on Thursday to mark Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s birthday, including the lighting of 1.25 lakh diyas at Kartavya Path, a mega blood donation camp, a 108-kund yagya and the launch of ‘Namo Shramik Seva Kendra’.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said the programmes will be part of the month-long ‘Seva Sankalp Abhiyan’, being organised to mark 25 years of the Prime

Minister’s public life.

The campaign will also see inauguration and foundation stone-laying for projects related to transport, roads, sewerage, water treatment, education, electricity, public facilities and urban beautification, according to the government. Under the ‘Aashirwad Ka Diya’ campaign, 1.25 lakh diyas will be lit at Kartavya Path at 7 pm.

The government said beneficiaries of welfare schemes and other citizens will participate in the programme. Gupta has also appealed to Delhi residents to light diyas at their homes

between 6 pm and 7 pm.

At Thyagaraj Stadium, a blood donation camp will be held from 11 am to 5 pm, with a target of collecting 2,500 units. Blood banks from 11 Delhi government hospitals, along with the Army Hospital, Lady Hardinge College, Safdarjung Hospital and the Indian Red Cross Society, will participate.

A 108-kund yagya will be organised at Khatu Shyam Delhi Dham on GT Karnal Road in Alipur. Visually impaired children will also recite the Hanuman Chalisa during the programme.

No idol immersion in Yamuna & other water bodies: DPCC

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA  
New Delhi, September 16

In light of Ganeshotsav and Durga Puja celebrations, the Delhi Pollution Control Committee has prohibited the immersion of idols in the Yamuna and other water bodies in the national capital, except at designated sites identified by local authorities. The DPCC directions issued on September 9 under Section 33A of the Water (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1974, have asked idol makers and sellers to use natural clay, biodegradable materials and natural dyes.

Plaster of Paris-based idols should not be allowed for immersion in water bodies, the DPCC said, emphasising that the order comes in light of Ganeshotsav and Durga Puja celebrations, where it has been a tradition to immerse idols in water bodies like rivers, lakes, ponds and wells.

The directions were issued in accordance with the revised guidelines of the Central Pollution Control Board issued in May 2020.

The DPCC said idol



immersion contributes to silting and deterioration of water quality, including changes in conductivity, biochemical oxygen demand and heavy-metal concentrations. Chemical paints and dyes used on idols may contain hazardous elements such as mercury, chromium, lead and cadmium, posing risks to aquatic life and public health, it said.

The DPCC cited orders of the National Green Tribunal dated January 13 and September 16, 2015, prohibiting waste, puja material, food grains, oil and other materials into the Yamuna except at designated locations.

District magistrates have been directed to enforce the restrictions. Violators may be liable to pay an environmental compensation of Rs 50,000, which will be deposited with the DPCC, according to the order.

Minister reviews blood camp prep

OUR CORRESPONDENT  
New Delhi, September 16

Health Minister Pankaj Kumar Singh on Wednesday inspected preparations for a mega blood donation camp scheduled at Thyagaraj Stadium on September 17, as part of the Delhi gov-

ernment’s Sewa Pakhwada programme.

The minister reviewed arrangements for donor registration, screening, blood collection, medical assistance, security, ambulance services, sanitation and crowd management along with senior officials and rep-

resentatives of concerned departments. Singh directed officials to ensure all facilities are in place before the camp begins and called for coordination among departments to facilitate participation while ensuring a safe and convenient experience for donors.

Delhi tops IEMI 2025

OUR CORRESPONDENT  
New Delhi, September 16

Delhi has secured the top position in the India Electric Mobility Index (IEMI) 2025 released by NITI Aayog, scoring 84 points, according to the Delhi government. The index assesses States and Union Territories on parameters including transport electrification, charging infrastructure, and research and innovation. The government said the recognition comes amid efforts to expand electric public transport and charging infrastructure in the capital. Delhi has set a target of deploying 14,000 electric buses by 2028-29, while work is also underway to increase the availability of EV charging facilities.

Transport Minister Pankaj Kumar Singh said “the ranking reflected the devel-

opment of Delhi’s electric mobility ecosystem and the government’s focus on clean and sustainable transport.”

The government attributed the progress to measures under the Delhi EV Policy 2026, including financial incentives for EV buyers and expansion of charging infrastructure. It said the focus is not only on increasing EV numbers but also on developing supporting infrastructure and electrifying public transport.

The IEMI is intended to track the progress, challenges and opportunities in electric mobility across States and Union Territories and facilitate sharing of policies and practices. NITI Aayog’s official material describes the index as a tool for tracking state and UT performance across 16 key indicators related to the EV ecosystem.

## Sashakt Divyangjan Samarth Bharat

We are working steadfastly towards ensuring an inclusive, accessible and equitable future for our Divyang sisters and brothers.

— Narendra Modi, Prime Minister

Through “Samajik Adhikarita Shivirs” at **76** locations across the country, the Government of India will distribute assistive devices free of cost to Divyangjan and Senior Citizens under the ADIP Scheme, Rashtriya Vayoshri Yojana & CSR

Camps organised at various locations across the country

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17 September, 2026

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Live link : [https://youtube.com/live/9\\_HDm6wcA78?feature=share](https://youtube.com/live/9_HDm6wcA78?feature=share)

Divyangjan can apply for assistive devices at: <https://adip.depwd.gov.in>

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REJECTS JOINT COMMISSION

‘No boundary between Pakistan & China’: India

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE  
New Delhi, September 16

India, on Wednesday, unequivocally rejected the ‘so-called’ Pakistan-China Boundary Joint Commission, arguing that there is no legally established boundary between Pakistan and China in respect of territories belonging to India. The stern diplomatic reaction came just days after the 18th BRICS Summit in New Delhi, wherein Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Chinese President Xi Jinping met to bring a long-term perspective to India-China relations.

Responding to queries regarding this matter, spokesperson of the Ministry of External Affairs, Randhir Jaiswal said that India’s stand on the matter is “clear and consistent,” rejecting the joint mechanism as a ‘baseless’ move. Further, he added that Pakistan did



not have any locus standi to make such an arrangement with China over territories that are illegally and forcibly occupied by Pakistan.

Jaiswal stressed that all of the Union Territories of Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh “have been, are and will always remain” integral and inalienable parts of India. At the same

time, he noted the consistent stance of New Delhi with respect to the China-Pakistan Boundary Agreement of 1963, which it had never recognised as a legal and valid one.

The China-Pakistan Boundary Agreement was signed by China and Pakistan in 1963, and the matter concerns territory in the

northern areas of Jammu and Kashmir that was illegally occupied by Pakistan. The Indian government believes that Pakistan cannot conduct any territorial negotiations related to its own territory that it illegally occupies.

The timing of the latest statement gains much significance since India and China have been trying to normalise their bilateral relations lately. This is evident from the discussion between Modi and Xi at the BRICS summit concerning the future course of action regarding India-China relations as well as their plans to bolster trade relations and enhance people-to-people contact.

Nevertheless, it is worth mentioning that the latest statement of the Ministry of External Affairs does not imply that India is compromising its stance on sov-

ereignty and territorial integrity with regard to the latest attempt at improving India-China relations. India has persistently opposed the Chinese activities in areas of Jammu and Kashmir occupied by Pakistan, especially in connection with the China-Pakistan Economic Corridor.

Furthermore, the problem should also be examined in light of the growing strategic partnership between China and Pakistan. Both countries refer to their relationship as an ‘all-weather’ one, which is characterised by collaboration in defence, infrastructure, connectivity, commerce, technology and diplomacy. China is still one of Pakistan’s key strategic and economic partners and the two countries have been implementing the China-Pakistan Economic Corridor and other connectivity initiatives.

MPOST BUREAU  
Prayagraj, September 16

The Allahabad High Court has said that UP Goondas Act is being used as a tool of oppression by Uttar Pradesh bureaucrats and the state despite the court’s consistent rulings on the issue and warned the bureaucracy of punitive damages if it does not stop issuing illegal and arbitrary orders.

The court awarded Rs 50,000 as damages to petitioner Abhishek Tyagi against whom proceedings under Goonda Act were initiated.

It said the state government was at liberty to recover the damages from the salaries of the bureaucrats concerned.

Justice Sandeep Jain held that the bureaucracy must stop issuing illegal and arbitrary orders, or else it will

have to face punitive damages. The court in its order dated September 10 allowed the petition of Tyagi, who had challenged proceedings initiated against him under the Uttar Pradesh Control of Goondas Act, 1970.

The court quashed the orders passed by the Additional Commissioner of Police, Ghaziabad and the Commissioner, Meerut Division. Proceedings against Tyagi under Goonda Act were initiated on the basis of two criminal cases. The ACP, Ghaziabad by an order dated September 18, 2025 directed Tyagi to reside at his permanent address and mark his attendance at the police station concerned on every second and fourth Saturday for six months.

His appeal against the order was subsequently dismissed by the Commis-

sioner, Meerut Division on December 10, 2025.

The court said that despite its consistent stand that a person cannot be branded a ‘goonda’ merely on the basis of one or two cases, the bureaucracy had “deliberately not noticed this” and was continuing to pass contrary orders.

“Moreover, there is a gap of 3 years in the occurrence of the two criminal cases which shows that he is not a habitual offender,” the court added.

It then observed, “It is apparent that the Act of 1970 is being used as a tool of oppression by the bureaucracy and the State which is contrary to the objects of the Act of 1970.”

The court further said time has now come for a strong message to be sent to the bureaucracy to stop such conduct or face punitive damages.

From page 1

Govt, Oppn

The government’s clarification comes after the Congress suggested the fee was being introduced to address US grievances that UPI and RuPay had hurt Visa and Mastercard.

Ending nearly six years of fully free UPI payments, the government had on Tuesday introduced a 0.4 per cent fee on transfers worth more than Rs 2,000 made to merchants through the platform from October 15, while ring-fencing person-to-person transactions as well as small payments from any charge.

The finance ministry clarified on Wednesday that there was no foreign influence behind the decision to impose a 0.4 per cent MDR (Merchant Discount Rate) on UPI transactions above Rs 2,000.

“Some claims suggest the change is due to foreign influence. This is false. India’s UPI policy decisions are made independently, with the clear goal of building a self-sustaining, inclusive, and affordable digital payments ecosystem,” the finance ministry said in a post on X.

Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi accused Prime Minister Narendra Modi of trying to please US President Donald Trump by imposing the charge.

The Congress alleged that the PM “redefined NOTA -- Narendra’s Ongoing Trump Appeasement”. Gandhi urged the PM to “stop lying down in front of the US, have a spine, stand up” and roll back the “UPI tax”.

“Modi ji, roll back the UPI tax. Now,” Gandhi said in his post on X.

Sources said the decision to impose MDR charges was taken in the larger interest of the UPI ecosystem and to strengthen its safety and security.

The decision to levy charges, as prevalent in other countries, was taken at the time of introduction of the UPI system, sources said, adding that the new MDR framework would make the platform self-sustainable.

The decision evoked strong opposition from several quarters, including traders, shopkeepers and political parties who dubbed the move as ‘Modi Tax’. Traders’ associations said they would push for cash payments to avoid additional costs on digital payments.

“(Former prime minister) Indira (Gandhi) ji was once asked whether she leans left or right and her response was ‘I don’t lean left, I don’t lean right, I stand straight’.

Modi ji has a completely different concept, he is neither left nor right, he has decided to lie down straight and prostrate himself in front of Donald Trump,” Rahul Gandhi alleged.

“He (Modi) has put a tax on every single Indian person by taxing UPI and giving a huge

amount of money to the United States,” Gandhi said in a video in which he is seen standing before a portrait of his grandmother Indira Gandhi.

Communist Party of India (CPI) general secretary D Raja demanded that the government withdraw the “anti-people decision”.

“Charges on UPI usage, a publicly developed payment technology, are deeply unfortunate and have been brought under US pressure,” Raja claimed in a post on X.

Congress general secretary in-charge communications Jairam Ramesh asked whether the MDR was announced to enable US card companies to compete with UPI.

In a post on X, Ramesh said the US House of Representatives will on Thursday vote on a bill that proposes 100 per cent tariffs on India. The US Senate has already approved this draconian law, he pointed out.

Ramesh also took a swipe at the government while tagging a finance ministry post of June 2025, which stated that claims that the MDR would be charged on UPI transactions were completely false. “The U-turn Ustad owes an explanation for his somersault,” he said.

“... the Modi government has given in to a US demand to get rid of zero MDR and charge for UPI. The US Trade Representative earlier this year criticised UPI for being free and having driven out Visa and Mastercard,” Ramesh said, while raising the issue of Trump cracking down on Indian immigrants and making tougher laws against them.

Addressing a press conference, Congress spokesperson Supriya Shrinate said huge volumes of transactions happen through UPI, and PM Modi has once again decided to take money out of people’s pockets.

Echoing the Congress sentiment, TMC MP Saugata Roy said levying a fee on UPI transactions would lead to an increase in the price of most commodities.

In Patna, RJD MP Manoj Jha flayed the government on the issue. “This is not a decision taken of their own accord, with their own wisdom. When we talk about American imperialism, this is like bowing down before it,” he said.

Earlier, Parliament’s Standing Committee on Finance, in its 32nd report, warned that the zero-MDR regime “puts pressure on government finances” and limits the ecosystem’s ability to invest in long-term infrastructure. It had also urged that “establishing a viable revenue mechanism is critical to ensuring the UPI ecosystem achieves financial sustainability without perpetually straining the government exchequer”.

The latest move signalled the end of an era for the world’s largest real-time payments system even as the government tried to avoid alarming the hundreds of millions of daily users.

UPI MDR

Under the proposed framework, merchant payments (P2M) above Rs 2,000 will attract an MDR of 0.4 per cent, capped at Rs 300. A concessional flat MDR of Rs 5 will apply to categories including railways, telecom, insurance and fuel.

The share of P2M transactions above Rs 2,000 has risen from 15.1 per cent in FY23 to 20.1 per cent in the June quarter of FY27, indicating growing use of UPI for higher-value purchases. AMRG Global Managing Partner Rajat Mohan said the 18 per cent GST would apply only to the MDR, not the transaction value. He estimated annual GST collections at Rs 3,500-Rs 4,000 crore.

Nangia Global Executive Director Sivakumar Ramjee said businesses with taxable GST output could claim ITC, while those dealing in exempt supplies would have to bear the tax. He estimated potential annual collections at over Rs 5,000 crore.

AKM Global’s Ikesh Nagpal calculated that Rs 6 lakh crore in monthly high-value merchant payments could generate about Rs 432 crore in monthly GST, or Rs 5,184 crore annually, before exemptions and caps.

India summons

According to official sources, the Pakistani vessel, identified as PNS Hunain, approached the Indian warship at high speed and manoeuvred in an unsafe and unprofessional manner, resulting in the collision. Hunain, an offshore patrol vessel, suffered heavy damage, while the Indian warship did not sustain any significant damage and continued its assigned mission in the region. The Ministry of External Affairs said there were no major consequences from the incident.

The MEA said the conduct of the Pakistani naval unit was in breach of Article 10 of the April 1991 Agreement between India and Pakistan on Advance Notice on Military Exercises, Manoeuvres and Troops Movements. The agreement forms part of bilateral confidence-building measures intended to reduce the risk of military incidents.

“While the incident, which took place in international waters, did not cause any major damage, the conduct of the Pakistani naval ship was in direct contravention of Article 10” of the agreement, the MEA said. Warraich was advised to convey to the relevant Pakistani authorities the need for all military units to exercise due care and comply with the provisions of the agreements between the two countries to prevent similar incidents.

India has also instructed its Charge d’Affaires in Islamabad to lodge a corresponding protest with Pakistan’s Ministry of Foreign Affairs.

The incident is the first publicly known military-domain incident between the two countries since the four-day hostili-

ties in May 2025 that followed the Pahalgam terror attack. Although the collision caused no major damage, its occurrence between frontline naval vessels in international waters has added a maritime dimension to the already sensitive security relationship between India and Pakistan.

Media reports identified Hunain as a Yarmook-class vessel. The MEA statement did not name the Pakistani ship or provide details of the damage.

India condemns

destroyed the drone south of the holy city on Tuesday evening, before it entered Makkah’s prohibited airspace. The Houthi denied targeting Makkah or any Islamic holy site.

“We are deeply concerned at the drone attack near Makkah,” External Affairs Ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said. He condemned attacks on Saudi sovereign territory and actions that endanger civilians and infrastructure, adding that the incident was particularly concerning because of Makkah’s significance to Muslims worldwide.

Saudi Arabia had placed parts of its western coast, including Makkah, on security alert following the incident. India had on Tuesday also condemned Houthi attacks on Saudi civilian infrastructure and economic assets, saying they threaten regional stability and freedom of navigation through the Bab-el-Mandeb strait.

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar discussed the West Asia situation with Saudi Foreign Minister Prince Faisal bin Farhan Al Saud on the sidelines of the BRICS summit on Sunday.

The Iran-backed Houthi, operating mainly from Yemen, have also targeted Saudi oil infrastructure, including the East-West pipeline, a key route for crude exports amid disruptions to shipping through the Strait of Hormuz. Their attacks have raised further concerns over the Bab-el-Mandeb shipping route connecting the Red Sea with the Gulf of Aden and Arabian Sea.

NDA leaders

in public office. The leaders will attend the flag-off of a bike rally to Vadnagar in Gujarat, Modi’s birthplace, as the BJP begins its month-long ‘Seva Sankalp Abhiyan’ featuring service and public outreach programmes across the country.

Naidu, who heads the Telugu Desam Party, is scheduled to visit the Kashi Vishwanath temple before joining the Varanasi programme, while Shinde has also confirmed his participation. Chirag Paswan, chief of the Lok Janshakti Party (Ram Vilas), and other NDA leaders are expected at the event. Meghalaya Chief Minister

Conrad Sangma, however, will not attend, according to his office. Rajnath Singh will flag off the Varanasi-to-Vadnagar bike rally, while Home Minister Amit Shah will simultaneously launch the Vadnagar-to-Varanasi rally in Gujarat. Gujarat Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel, Shinde, Union minister Anupriya Patel, Gujarat BJP president Jagdish Vishwakarma and BJP Yuva Morcha president Hemang Joshi are among those scheduled to be present in Vadnagar.

The two rallies will start on September 17 and conclude on October 7, covering nearly 40,000 km through 193 districts and around 1,159 villages across 10 states. Around 1,000 young people are expected to participate. Organisers said the riders will travel through different parts of the country before reaching their respective destinations.

The journeys will also be accompanied by public service activities, including cleanliness and tree plantation drives, water conservation initiatives and campaigns for a drug-free, tuberculosis-free and plastic-free India.

The programmes in Varanasi and Vadnagar form part of the BJP’s ‘Seva Diwas’ observance. In Delhi, BJP president Nitin Nabin will inaugurate a blood donation camp at the party headquarters before travelling to Madhya Pradesh for programmes in Indore and Ujjain. A nationwide cleanliness campaign is also planned.

The party will also organise lamp-lighting programmes in the evening, with ‘Aashirwad Ka Diya’ to be lit at hundreds of locations. Nabin will light the lamp at Ram Ghat in Ujjain.

The ‘Seva Sankalp Abhiyan’ will continue from September 17 to October 17 and include welfare outreach, exhibitions, seminars and programmes focused particularly on young people. Nabin is also scheduled to launch a statewide public welfare campaign under the Swamitva Scheme in Indore and attend the Bhasma Aarti at Mahakaleshwar Temple on Friday.

Modi served as Gujarat chief minister from October 2001 until May 2014, when he became prime minister. He was first elected to the Lok Sabha from Varanasi in 2014 and retained the seat in 2019 and 2024.

Govt raises EPF

The government said the latest revision takes into account wage growth, rising incomes and the expansion of formal employment since the previous increase.

Under the existing rules, employees joining a job with wages above Rs 15,000 a month are not automatically covered under mandatory EPF provisions. The new

threshold will bring a significant section of workers earning between Rs 15,000 and Rs 25,000 within the statutory social security framework. The annual government expenditure on the measure is estimated at about Rs 11,339 crore, compared with the existing annual budgetary support of around Rs 10,250 crore. The estimated expenditure over five years is approximately Rs 56,696 crore.

Labour and Employment Minister Mansukh Mandaviya said on X that the decision would broaden social security coverage and support the formalisation of employment. He said the revised ceiling would come into force on the occasion of Vishwakarma Jayanti and Service Day.

EPFO currently has about 7.98 crore contributing members across around 7.68 lakh contributing establishments. Its pension scheme provides benefits to about 82 lakh pensioners, while EDLI offers insurance protection linked to EPF membership.

Lifetime free

The new system, approved by the government for railway concessions to gallantry award recipients, will be entirely digital and paperless. Eligible awardees will be able to book tickets through IRTC from November 1, 2026, after registering on the Indian Railways Concession and Compensation Portal (IRCCP).

After identity verification, beneficiaries will receive an electronic travel document allowing them to travel in first class and in an AC chair car along with one companion.

The concession will also cover certain eligible family members. Spouses will be entitled to the benefit, while widows and widowers can avail it until they remarry. In cases where an unmarried Armed Forces member is awarded the gallantry medal posthumously, the concession will also be available to eligible parents.

The benefit is limited to the gallantry category of the three medals and does not apply to all recipients. The Sena Medal is awarded by the Army, while the Nau Sena Medal and Vayu Sena Medal are the corresponding service decorations of the Navy and Air Force.

The Ministry of Defence has introduced the digital system to simplify registration, verification, issuance of travel documents and ticket booking, while removing the need for physical railway concession documents.

The decision follows a government order on railway concessions for gallantry award recipients. A letter dated March 16, 2026, was issued in this regard. Rail Ministry officials did not respond to queries on the matter.

The extension comes in a

year when the government has announced several measures recognising the service and bravery of Armed Forces personnel. Ahead of Republic Day 2026, the President approved gallantry awards for 70 Armed Forces personnel, including six posthumous awards.

Actor Anant

cinema, will be presented at the National Film Awards ceremony in Kevadia, Gujarat, on September 22.

The Press Information Bureau said the decision followed the recommendation of the Dadasaheb Phalke Award Selection Committee and recognised Nag’s “illustrious cinematic journey”. Prime Minister Narendra Modi congratulated Nag, saying his performances and versatility had left a strong mark on Indian cinema, particularly Kannada cinema.

Nag made his film debut with the 1973 Kannada film Sankalpa and became a prominent figure in parallel cinema during the 1970s and 1980s. His collaboration with filmmaker Shyam Benegal included Ankur, Nishant, Manthan, Bhumika, Kondura and Kalyug.

His performance in Hamsageethe (1975) earned him the National Film Award for Best Feature Film in Kannada. He also appeared in Malgudi Days and several commercial Kannada films, including KGF. Nag received the Padma Bhushan last year. Malayalam star Mohanlal received the Phalke Award last year.

Fertility falls

couples to two children. It called for the withdrawal of family-planning awards, World Population Day celebrations and Vasectomy Fortnight observances that promote population control.

The EAC-PM further proposed repealing two-child norm-based disqualifications across states and changing the scope of Mission Parivar Vikas to reflect the demographic situation in states at or below replacement fertility.

“Remove all fertility reduction, population control or ‘stabilisation’ language from our national and state policy frameworks and outputs,” the paper said. The council noted that several states have remained below replacement fertility for more than two decades. These include Andhra Pradesh at 1.4, Telangana and Karnataka at 1.5 each, Kerala and Tamil Nadu at 1.3 each, West Bengal at 1.3, Punjab at 1.4, Goa at 1.6, Himachal Pradesh at 1.5, Sikkim at 1.0, Maharashtra at 1.4 and Delhi at 1.2.

India’s annual births have also declined from about 29.3 million in 2001 to around 23.2 million in 2023, a fall of roughly one-fifth. The 2023 figure is similar to the number recorded about 50 years ago, in 1974.



EDITORIAL

Sharing Risks  
Driving Growth

Indian Railways is entering a phase in which the scale of its ambitions is beginning to exceed what conventional public financing and execution can comfortably deliver. The network must simultaneously add capacity, modernise stations, expand freight infrastructure, introduce new-generation rolling stock, improve logistics and maintain safety across one of the world's largest railway systems. The Centre has substantially increased budgetary support, with Rs 2.78 lakh crore provided for 2026-27, but public money alone cannot indefinitely carry every dimension of this transformation. This explains the renewed emphasis on public-private partnerships. The objective is not simply to substitute private capital for government expenditure. Properly structured, PPPs can bring technology, specialised management, faster execution and commercial discipline into projects while allowing the Railways to concentrate public resources on safety, socially necessary services and network expansion where commercial returns may be limited.

The important change is that the Railways appears to be learning from the mixed experience of earlier PPP experiments. A single template cannot work equally well for passenger trains, stations, freight terminals, manufacturing facilities and connectivity projects. The emerging approach therefore relies on models tailored to the economics and risks of individual sectors. There is already evidence of where partnership can work. Locomotive manufacturing projects at Madhepura and Marhowra have combined long-term procurement with private technology and manufacturing capabilities. The Gati Shakti Multi-Modal Cargo Terminal policy has mobilised private investment for freight infrastructure, while station redevelopment and other projects are testing different arrangements. Indian Railways is also revising older PPP frameworks and simplifying rules for private freight participation. The underlying principle should be straightforward: risks must sit with the party best equipped to manage them. Construction, technology and certain commercial risks can often be handled more efficiently by private partners; network control, safety regulation and the wider public-service obligation must remain firmly protected.

Yet PPP must not become shorthand for transferring profitable railway assets while the public sector absorbs the difficult obligations. Railways is unlike an airport, highway or ordinary commercial enterprise. It performs an enormous social function, connects remote regions and provides affordable mobility to millions. Any partnership model must therefore be transparent about tariffs, service standards, concession periods, revenue sharing and risk allocation. Contracts must also anticipate demand fluctuations instead of relying on optimistic traffic projections that later lead to renegotiation. Independent monitoring and clearly enforceable performance standards are essential if private participation is to produce efficiency rather than merely guaranteed returns.

The case for new PPP models ultimately rests on pragmatism. India needs a railway system capable of supporting a much larger economy, moving more freight from road to rail and delivering better passenger services without allowing investment requirements to overwhelm public finances. Private capital can accelerate that transition, but capital alone is not reform. The real test is whether partnerships produce infrastructure faster, improve services, distribute risks fairly and protect the railway's public character. If those principles guide the next generation of contracts, PPP can become not a retreat of the state, but a more effective way of expanding its capacity to deliver.

LETTER



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Wider Safety Net

The higher EPFO wage ceiling is a welcome expansion of social security for salaried workers. Bringing more employees within mandatory provident fund coverage can strengthen long-term retirement savings as wages rise. However, implementation must ensure that higher contributions do not disproportionately squeeze take-home salaries of lower- and middle-income workers.

SHASIKANT MITTAL,  
BHOPAL

You can also send your comments to The Editor, Millennium Post, Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002

Building Stronger Foundations

*Ek Tara's SELI shows how school libraries, trained educators and joyful learning can strengthen foundational literacy while creating a scalable model for government schools*

NEXUS  
OF GOOD



ANIL SWARUP

THE WRITER IS AN AUTHOR AND  
A FORMER CIVIL SERVANT

Ek Tara's Strengthening Early Learning Initiative (SELI) began in 2022-23 as a modest intervention across five government schools, reaching 1,000 children through two components: the Golpo Ghor library and structured FLN remedial classes for Grades 1 to 5. The premise was simple: children in Kolkata's urban slum areas are enrolled in government schools but are not truly learning, held back by overcrowded classrooms, a lack of resources, the absence of print-rich environments and multilingual homes with no literacy support.

Three years on, SELI operates across 28 government primary schools under the Kolkata Primary School Council (KPSC) and Kolkata Municipal Corporation (KMC), reaching 4,403 children. Along the way, the programme evolved: what began as two components grew into a fuller offering spanning library-based

learning, FLN remediation, STEAM exposure and co-curricular activities – all grounded in NEP 2020, the NIPUN Bharat Mission and NCF-FS 2022.

The need remains urgent. PARAKH 2024, India's national learning assessment, shows West Bengal's Class 3 students scoring 58 per cent in Language and 53 per cent in Mathematics – both below the national averages of 64 per cent and 60 per cent.

Against this backdrop, SELI's own baseline-to-endline data tell a strong story. Across the 28 schools, the share of children at the lowest (Emergent) literacy level fell from 65 per cent at baseline to 30 per cent at end-line, with children advancing across every higher proficiency band. FY 2024-25 assessments recorded double-digit gains in both Numeracy and Language for Classes 3-5.

Within the programme, a distinct pattern emerged. The library component was originally designed as a supplementary activity. But it has consistently shown stronger engagement, deeper language growth and more sustained learning behaviours among children. Children who participate regularly in this library programme demonstrate not only better reading comprehension and oral language confidence, but also higher attendance motivation, richer vocabulary and greater social-emotional wellbeing – outcomes that direct instruction alone has struggled to produce at the same depth.

This pattern is not incidental. It reflects a fundamental insight into how young children from low-literacy, high-stress urban slum environments actually learn: not only through drills and remedial classes, but through joyful, meaning-rich engagement



SELI turns joyful learning into a scalable model for change

STRONG SCHOOL  
LIBRARIES CAN TURN  
FOUNDATIONAL  
LITERACY INTO A  
SUSTAINABLE PUBLIC  
PARTNERSHIP

with books, stories and creative expression.

15 government primary schools now have functioning libraries, and 13 have classroom reading corners, stocked with 500+ curated, contextual, age-appropriate books. The full SELI programme, spanning library sessions and FLN remediation, is implemented on the ground by a team of 22 educators trained through DIKSHA and the NISHTHA FLN course.

SELI's Phase II (2026-2030) sharpens the focus on "Literacy Enhancement" through library sessions for Classes I-V, in response to persistent gaps in reading fluency, comprehension and vocabulary. The vision is for

the library to become not a supplementary space but the pedagogical anchor of early learning – supported by print-rich classrooms, trained facilitators and two weekly library sessions per class embedded in the school timetable.

The RTE Act, 2009, already mandates a library in every school (Schedule Item 6). Hence, Ek Tara activates the very intention that already exists, at a fraction of the cost of new infrastructure: one room or corner, curated books and one trained facilitator per school. So, no new policy sanction is needed, only implementation support.

Sessions are time-tabled within the existing school day, requiring no extra staff time or school hours. Most importantly, the model is built to hand over, not hold on. By Year 3 in each school, library management transfers fully to the school – so the schools inherit sustained capacity, not a standing dependency on an NGO.

Complementing SELI's in-school library model is Chakke Pe Kaksha (CPK) – Ek Tara's mobile school, run in partnership with the Belgian organisation Mobile School since 2016,

when it became India's first mobile school. CPK is built around a six-metre, two-sided, extendable blackboard on wheels carrying over 360 interactive learning panels, taken directly to children in slums, streets and, increasingly, government school premises. It has reached 20,000+ children cumulatively, blending literacy and numeracy with life skills, creative activities, health and hygiene awareness and, most importantly, self-esteem.

As SELI scales, CPK offers a natural extension inside government school campuses: a low-infrastructure, high-engagement complement to the library programme that can reach children and the community – building interest in reading, supporting outreach and enrolment drives and reinforcing SELI's literacy goals through play. Currently operational in six schools, Ek Tara plans to bring CPK sessions to new schools to widen its impact without diluting quality.

Ek Tara's SELI journey – from five schools and under 1,000 children to a 28-school, 4,400-child programme with a formal government partnership – reflects an underlying conviction: that the school library, not the worksheet, is where sustainable foundational learning takes root. With committed government partners and complementary programmes like Chakke Pe Kaksha, Ek Tara aims to make that library the dynamic, lifelong-learning hub every child in every partner school deserves.

SELI's journey is a wonderful example of the Nexus of Good. The model they have put in place is replicable and scalable in the true spirit of the Nexus of Good through public-private partnership.

*Views expressed are personal*

Building India's Sickle Cell Response

*From affordable screening and newborn diagnosis to long-term research and stigma measurement, ICMR is building a comprehensive scientific response to India's heavy sickle cell disease burden*

HEALTH  
HORIZONS



RAJIV BAHL &  
MANISHA R MADHAKAR

R BAHL IS DIRECTOR GENERAL,  
ICMR AND M.R. MADHAKAR IS  
DIRECTOR, ICMR, NIRBID

Change a single letter among the three billion-letter human genetic code, and a red blood cell that should be round and supple stiffens into a rigid crescent that snags in the bloodstream. That one change is sickle cell disease, which for those who live with it brings episodes of excruciating pain, chronic anaemia, heightened vulnerability to infection, and cumulative organ damage over a lifetime. India carries one of the heaviest burdens of this disease in the world. Nearly 88 per cent of people in Asia with the most severe form of the condition are Indian. It falls hardest on tribal communities. The health ministry ranks the disease among the ten that most affect them.

Confronted with a burden of this scale, India has resolved to act. In July 2023, Hon'ble Prime Minister Narendra Modi launched the National Sickle Cell Anaemia Elimination Mission, setting an ambitious national

goal to end sickle cell disease as a public health problem by 2047. Its reach has been considerable. By 31 July 2025, 6.07 crore people had been screened across seventeen high-prevalence states, with over 2.15 lakh diagnosed and 16.7 lakh identified as carriers. Within ICMR, this scientific effort is led by its National Institute for Research on Blood and Immune Disorders (ICMR-NIRBID) in Mumbai and driven on the ground by the institute's Centre for Research, Management and Control of Haemoglobinopathies (ICMR-CRMCH) at Chandrapur. It is from this base that ICMR has equipped the national mission with the tools it depends on.

The first of those tools was a dependable and affordable point-of-care test. Requiring only a drop of blood and providing results within minutes, these tests have made large-scale screening feasible in resource-constrained settings. Their widespread adoption was supported by a cost-effectiveness assessment undertaken through the Department of Health Research's Health Technology Assessment in India (HTAIn) programme, alongside ICMR-led validation of more than 25 rapid diagnostic technologies. Together, these efforts helped reduce the cost of screening from nearly Rs 350 to about Rs 25 per test, making population-level screening both practical and affordable.

Equally important is the expansion of newborn screening (NBS). Evidence from several countries has demonstrated that early identification of affected infants, followed by simple interventions such as prophylactic medications, immunisation, nutritional supplementation and timely initiation of treatment, can reduce severe complications and thus improve survival. A



Screening costs have fallen from nearly Rs 350 to about Rs 25

INDIA'S 2047  
AMBITION TURNS A  
NEGLECTED INHERITED  
DISORDER INTO A  
NATIONAL PRIORITY

multi-centric study conducted by the ICMR across 6 high-prevalence districts, screening more than 68,000 newborn babies for SCD, has demonstrated the positive outcomes, feasibility and challenges for its implementation at the national level. Those identified with sickle cell disease were immediately started on simple, affordable interventions: folic acid, prophylaxis to prevent infections, and pneumococcal vaccination. The results were remarkable. The death rate among these children fell to below 5 per cent. Without screening and early treatment, that figure is between 20 and 30 per cent. Integrating newborn screening into routine health services in high-burden districts can be a transformative step towards reducing preventable complications and deaths.

Equally important is understanding what happens to patients over time. While screening programmes identify those affected and newborn screening enables early intervention, improving long-term outcomes requires a deeper understanding of how the disease progresses across diverse populations. To address this need, ICMR has initiated Bharat CARES (Bharat Cohorts for Assessment of Burden and Progression of End-organ Damage from Sickle Cell Disease) through its National Health Research Programme (NHRP). This multi-centric cohort study is designed to track disease patterns, complications, treatment outcomes and the progression of organ damage among individuals living with sickle cell disease. By generating high-quality longitudinal data from across the country, the study will strengthen risk assessment, support earlier identification of complications, inform clinical decision-making and help refine public health strategies. In doing so, it seeks to ensure that care is guided not only by what is known about the disease today, but also by a clearer understanding of its long-term trajectory in the Indian context.

Yet the disease is not only clinical. Stigma and misunderstanding delay diagnosis, discourage treatment and weigh on families, particularly in the tribal communities where it concentrates. In response, ICMR developed and validated India's first instrument to measure sickle cell disease stigma, only the fourth such tool in the world, addressing a dimension that clinical data alone cannot capture. It measures five dimensions of stigma, including the fear around marriage and reproduction, the difficulty of disclosing a diagnosis, and the challenges families face when seeking healthcare. It exists in both a patient version and a caregiver version, because the burden falls on the whole family, not just the person who is ill. With this tool, health programmes can now measure whether their community outreach is actually shifting attitudes, and adjust accordingly.

The deeper lesson is that durable progress comes only from the convergence of science, policy and community. Screening, newborn diagnosis, clinical research, genetic counselling, public awareness and patient-centred care are not separate initiatives but interconnected parts of a single public health response. India's progress will be defined not by any one programme, but by sustained scientific inquiry, institutional commitment and the engagement of the communities most affected. With researchers, health workers, policymakers and families working in concert, the goal of substantially reducing its burden can move from aspiration to reality, and a child born today in a remote district can look forward to far better prospects than one born a generation ago.

*Views expressed are personal*

# PM Modi and Awakening Atma Shakti

*On his 76<sup>th</sup> birthday, PM Narendra Modi’s political journey can be viewed alongside Tagore’s call to awaken Atma Shakti through self-reliance, service and national self-confidence*

## ROOTED IN BHARAT



ANIRBAN GANGULY

THE WRITER IS MEMBER NEC, BJP & CHAIRMAN, DR SYAMA PRASAD MOOKERJEE RESEARCH FOUNDATION

In his famous treatise “Swadeshi Samaj”, written in the heyday of the Swadeshi era, Gurudev Rabindranath Tagore spoke of awakening our “Atmashakti”, or “Self-Power”, for achieving self-reliance. Tagore lamented that India, which was once primarily a society- and people-driven polity, where initiative and self-help were the norm, had now lost that capacity. It was now dependent on petitions and representations.

The need was to reawaken energy, sincerity, self-reliance and courage. Gurudev advocated the need to concentrate all scattered national forces in one centre. For him, every external blow only paved the way for uniting all strength in a common centre and for a common goal.

It was only through serving the nation, “swadesher-seva”, that genuine love of the nation, “swadesh-prem”, could be awakened, Gurudev argued. It was through national seva that the vision of the nation, *desh*, could in itself emerge. Such a centre of seva would unite all sections of people in a common bond. “Atma-Shakti” can be awakened by discovering yourself in the larger national self. That identification with the larger national self can emerge by serving the country, “*desh-seva*”.

Each time I return to the pages of “Swadeshi Samaj”, I find a striking resemblance between its call to action and Narendra Modi’s governance approach and actions in the last quarter-century that he has been in elected office.

Self-reliance, identification with the larger national self, *seva* of the nation and awakening the “self-power”, “Atma-Shakti”, have been intrinsic to Modi’s vision and philosophy of governance. The swaraj for the swadeshi samaj, Tagore argued, would come about through swaraj of society, and that swaraj could only re-emerge through self-help.

In the last 25 years – as Chief Minister of Gujarat and later as Prime Minister of India – Modi’s way of bringing about transformation has been to base it on the collective strength of the people and to awaken their *Atma Shakti*.

Modi appeals to India’s civilisational capacity for self-renewal. That capacity had been sapped. For long decades after freedom, insufficient attention was paid to its reawakening. That capacity for self-renewal is India’s civilisational strength; it can be sustained through *Atma-Shakti*.



Self-reliance has remained central to PM Narendra Modi’s governance philosophy

*Atma Shakti* diminished under the onslaught of a foreign education system and foreign systems. They eventually overwhelmed our capacity for self-help. When Modi spoke of “*Panch-Pran*”, five pledges for national and civilisational self-renewal, and when he spoke of *de-Macaulayising* the Indian polity, setting a decadal goal till 2035, Modi was working to reawaken *Atma Shakti*.

That awakening is seen through a confident cultural self-recovery. “Macaulay shattered our self-confidence,” Modi observes. “He infused a sense of inferiority within us. With one

## PM MODI’S IDEA OF NATIONAL RENEWAL BEGINS WITH AWAKENING INDIA’S INNER STRENGTH

stroke he threw thousands of years of our knowledge and science, our art and culture, and our entire way of life into the dustbin. It was at that moment that

the seed was sown that if Indians wanted to progress, if they wanted to achieve something big, they would have to do so through foreign methods.”

This feeling persisted after independence. It made us base our methods and models on foreign theories and systems. The pride of being ourselves was diminished and nearly lost. When he called for taking a pledge to free ourselves from Macaulay’s mentality of slavery in the next ten years, Modi was speaking of the national prerogative and imperative of being ourselves. This was the second struggle for

independence. No Prime Minister before him has spoken in that vein or has set such a target.

Philosopher K.C. Bhattacharya has termed this aspiration “*Swaraj in Ideas*”, while Deendayal Upadhyaya, writing in 1949, spoke of “cultural freedom” being of paramount importance, minus which the nation’s freedom “will not only be meaningless, but will also not last long.” Modi’s *Panch Pran* and *de-Macaulayisation* aim at ushering in an era of swaraj in ideas and of true and lasting cultural freedom. Such an era of cultural freedom will no longer see our languages, traditions, culture and literature being denigrated or ridiculed.

In the aftermath of independence, Sri Aurobindo spoke of the “vast subtleties of the collective being of a people” in which resides “a power of self-renewal with the help of its inner life-idea.” This inner life-idea is “the key to a nation’s psychology and is more tenacious than the outer form.”

Modi’s approach in the last 25 years has been to emphasise the necessity of connecting with this inner life-idea. He knows it is the key to a civilisational resurgence. A number of fields in which he has striven to bring about a transformation point to this.

Modi is connected to the soil and soul of Bharat. He has grown from it, unlike some of his predecessors, who were deracinated from Bharat’s essence. That rootedness has led him to rise through struggles and trials, enabling him to create an entirely new age, catapulting Bharat towards a new future.

*Views expressed are personal*

# Turning Oceans into Engines of Growth

*Investment, technology and market diversification are transforming fisheries and aquaculture into powerful pillars of India’s Viksit Bharat ambitions*

## BLUE FRONTIERS



ABHILAKSH LIKHI

THE WRITER IS SECRETARY, DEPARTMENT OF FISHERIES, MINISTRY OF FISHERIES, ANIMAL HUSBANDRY & DAIRYING, GOI

On the occasion of India’s 80<sup>th</sup> Independence Day, the Hon’ble Prime Minister of India outlined the importance of a blue economy as one among the seven streams of reform and development (*Sapta Dhara*). A blue economy encompasses a framework for the sustainable, inclusive, and resilient management of our marine resources. Such an approach is closely aligned with Sustainable Development Goal (SDG) 14 of the United Nations, which emphasises the need to conserve and sustainably use the oceans and seas. During India’s 2023 G20 Presidency too, world leaders committed themselves to mainstreaming the need to build a resilient blue economy. In fact, a key pillar of India’s “Viksit Bharat” vision for 2047 is also the focus on a robust blue economy.

In this context, fisheries and aquaculture have a major role in leveraging the blue economy through the nation’s extensive 11,098-km coastline and vast 2.4-million-square-kilometre Exclusive Economic Zone (EEZ).

India is the second-largest fish-producing country in the world. It is, in addition, now also the second-largest nation in aquaculture production. As a result of cumulative investments of Rs 39,272 crore through flagship programmes during the last twelve years, the country has witnessed a 106 per cent increase in national fish production (which stands at a record 198 lakh tonnes in 2024-25). Interestingly, 75 per cent of this production comes from aquaculture powered by shrimp cultivation. The areas of investment include infrastructure development, technology infusion, and fishermen’s welfare.

On the other hand, during the last twelve years, our seafood exports have risen by 145 per cent and are valued at Rs 73,890 crore in 2025-26. These largely comprise cultured frozen shrimps exported to the USA. However, during the last year alone, despite the tariffs imposed by the USA, seafood exports have shown resilience, witnessing an increase of approximately Rs 11,000 crore! This has been possible due to aggressive market diversification of seafood exports to countries in the European Union, China, and Southeast Asia, coupled with the signing of Free Trade Agreements (FTAs).

To further leverage the blue economy through fisheries and aquaculture, the following key priority areas are being given a boost.

First, to enhance our seafood exports in high-value tuna and tuna-like species, we need to tap approximately 2.70 lakh tonnes of oceanic resources in our EEZ. The global trade in high-value fish species is worth US\$18 billion! Interestingly, almost 50 per cent of the area of India’s EEZ falls in the Andaman & Nicobar and Lakshadweep Islands. To unlock the above untapped potential, a sustainable governance framework has been notified for deep-sea fishing by Indian-flagged vessels in the EEZ as well as the High Seas. Fish Farmer Producer Organisations (FFPOs) and Fisheries Coopera-



Deep seas and smarter harbours can unlock India’s fisheries potential

tives will be important partners in this endeavour. The notification of the Andaman & Nicobar Islands as a “Tuna Cluster” will also enable entrepreneurs to become partners in its value-chain activities.

Second, reduction in post-harvest losses entails effective harbour management backed by requisite technology infusion. “Integrated and Smart Fish Harbours” have been conceptualised with digitalisation (application of IoT, AI, etc.) to track the traceability of fish catch and its certification, along with low-carbon-footprint initiatives. Four such fish harbours have been approved to be built at Vanakabara (Daman & Diu), Karaikal (Puducherry), Jakhau (Gujarat), and Mayabundar (Andaman & Nicobar Islands). This has been backed by a technical cooperation project with the Food and Agriculture Organisation (FAO) to build the requisite blue-port capacities of all stakeholders.

## INDIA’S COASTLINE HOLDS ENORMOUS OPPORTUNITIES FOR SUSTAINABLE GROWTH AND LIVELIHOODS

Moreover, value addition in shrimp/fish processing (ready-to-eat or ready-to-cook) needs to be enhanced from the current 11 per cent to 30 per cent over the next five years. Such seafood export processing units are primarily located in the states of Gujarat, Kerala, Maharashtra, Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka, Odisha, and Tamil Nadu. They are being strengthened with modern processing facilities such as breeding,

battering, filleting, freeze-drying, individual quick freezing, chilling, and canning lines.

Third, initiatives in mariculture (a specialised branch of aquaculture involving the cultivation of marine plants in the ocean or sea) need to be strengthened. In this context, seaweed farming’s future potential is multifaceted! It is a carbon sequester and, therefore, an effective instrument in the nation’s effort to achieve net-zero carbon emissions by 2070. Its applications range from being a biostimulant in agriculture to serving as an input in the pharmaceutical, cosmetics, and mining industries. In India, seaweed grows abundantly along the coasts of Tamil Nadu and Gujarat and around the Lakshadweep Islands. This is being supplemented with research and culture demonstrations along the coastline to explore the scope for approximately 90 lakh tonnes of production. Offshore mechanised seaweed cultivation, in addition,

holds tremendous potential. The notification of the Lakshadweep Islands as a “Seaweed Cluster” will, therefore, enable entrepreneurs to contribute towards strengthening its value-chain activities.

As diverse global markets open up for our seafood exports, sustainability compliance is increasingly becoming a critical factor. Therefore, the need for sustainable fishing practices has always been emphasised to coastal State governments and Union Territories. These include a uniform ban on fishing during the breeding season, sea ranching, a ban on LED lights/bottom trawling, minimum fish mesh/legal size, an action plan for marine pollution as well as abandoned gear, the use of green fuels, turtle excluder devices, and artificial reefs. Besides, climate-proofing infrastructure in 100 coastal villages has also been taken up for implementation. In fact, a Central Marine Fisheries Research Institute (CMFRI) study is a testimony to the effective implementation of the above measures. The study concludes that 91.1 per cent of 135 marine fish stocks assessed for their abundance and level of harvest were found to be healthy in the EEZ.

To make the above pillars of the blue economy bottom-up, capacity building and skilling of approximately fifty lakh fisher families are also a must. International best practices from countries such as China, South Korea, Indonesia, the Maldives, France, Iceland, and Norway have been aggregated. These have enabled the creation of cutting-edge training modules on deep-sea vessel management, fish harbour logistics, and mariculture technologies. These training modules have, in fact, been grounded in convergence with ICAR “Krisi Vigyan Kendras”. All the above efforts align with the Viksit Bharat@2047 vision to empower fishermen’s families to thrive and contribute to the nation’s Blue Revolution.

*Views expressed are personal*

JUSTICE AFTER 13 YEARS

All 10 convicts awarded death sentence in 2013 Maoist attack

OUR CORRESPONDENT  
Jagdalpur, September 16

A special NIA court in Chhattisgarh’s Bastar district on Wednesday handed down death penalty to all 10 convicts in the 2013 Jhiram Valley Maoist attack case, in which 29 people including senior Congress leaders, were killed.

Special judge of the National Investigation Agency (NIA) court in Jagdalpur, Ajay Singh Rajput, had convicted the 10 accused, including two women, on September 5 and reserved the order on the quantum of punishment for Wednesday, NIA counsel Dinesh Panigrahi told reporters.

“The court has awarded the death penalty to all 10 convicts,” Panigrahi said.

These 10 convicts were identified as Pramila Modiyam (40), Chaitu Lekam, Sumitra Punem Modiyam, Mukka Mandavi, Kosa Kavasi, Aayata Markam, Madkami Deva, Joga Madkami, Banjami Sanna and Mahadev Nag.

A total of 101 prosecution witnesses were examined during the trial and several documentary pieces of evidence were presented, Panigrahi said.

Asked about the total number of accused in the case, he said several identified and unidentified persons were named as accused in the FIR.

“Eleven persons were arrested and a trial was initiated against them. One of

CLOSER LOOK

- » These 10 convicts were identified as Pramila Modiyam (40), Chaitu Lekam, Sumitra Punem Modiyam, Mukka Mandavi, Kosa Kavasi, Aayata Markam, Madkami Deva, Joga Madkami, Banjami Sanna and Mahadev Nag
- » Maoists ambushed the Congress’ ‘Parivartan Rally’ ahead of the state Assembly elections on the national highway in Jhiram Valley in Bastar on May 25, 2013, the NIA said in a statement
- » As many as 29 people, including Congress leaders, civilians and security personnel, were killed and more than 30 others injured

them died during the trial and the remaining 10 were convicted after the trial,” he said.

Defence lawyer Arvind Choudhary said, “We are not satisfied with the verdict and will challenge it in the high court.”

According to the probe agency, the 10 convicts were found guilty under various sections of the Indian Penal Code, Arms Act, Explosive Substances Act and Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act.

Maoists ambushed the Congress’ ‘Parivartan Rally’ ahead of the state Assembly elections on the national highway in Jhiram Valley in Bastar on May 25, 2013, the NIA said in a statement.

As many as 29 people, including Congress leaders, civilians and security personnel, were killed and more than 30 others injured.

The Maoists triggered an IED blast, opened indiscriminate fire and detonated grenades at the

convoy, killing 24 people on the spot and injuring more than 35 civilians and police personnel, the NIA said. Three of the injured later succumbed to their injuries, taking the death toll to 29, it said.

The Maoists also looted arms and ammunition, walkie-talkie sets, mobile phones and other belongings from the victims, according to the agency.

Those killed included then state Congress chief Nand Kumar Patel and his son Dinesh, former Leader of Opposition in the Assembly Mahendra Karma, former Union minister Vidya Charan Shukla and senior Congress leader and former MLA Uday Mudliyar.

The NIA said its investigation established that armed cadres of the banned CPI (Maoist), in connivance with local committees and divisions, had entered into a criminal conspiracy to attack and kill senior Congress leaders and security personnel

travelling in the ‘Parivartan Yatra’ convoy as part of the outfit’s Tactical Counter Offensive Campaign (TCOC).

The state police had initially registered a case, but the then Raman Singh-led BJP government handed over the probe to the NIA within two days of the attack.

The NIA filed its first chargesheet against nine accused on September 25, 2014, and a supplementary chargesheet against 30 accused on September 28, 2015. Of the 11 accused arrested and put on trial, one died in judicial custody, the agency said.

The attack has remained a major political issue in Chhattisgarh, with the Congress repeatedly alleging that the larger conspiracy behind the incident was not properly investigated.

In January 2019, the then Bhupesh Baghel-led Congress government constituted a Special Investigation Team (SIT) to probe the attack, alleging that the NIA investigation had not covered the larger conspiracy.

Police subsequently registered a fresh FIR at Darbha police station on May 25, 2020, under sections 302 (murder) and 120B (criminal conspiracy) of the IPC against unidentified persons on a complaint by Jitendra Mudliyar, son of Congress leader Uday Mudliyar who was killed in the attack.

EAM Jaishankar discusses ‘development partnership’ with Bhutanese counterpart

Jaishankar is on a two-day official visit to Bhutan starting Wednesday

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA  
Thimphu, September 16

India and Bhutan discussed development partnership, energy, trade and connectivity as External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar held talks with his Bhutanese counterpart D N Dhungyel in Bumthang on Wednesday.

Jaishankar is on a two-day official visit to Bhutan starting Wednesday, during which he will also call on the King of Bhutan Jigme Khesar Namgyel Wangchuck and the Prime Minister of Bhutan Tshering Tobgay.

“Delighted to meet @FMBhutan Lyonpo D N Dhungyel and jointly review our wide - ranging cooperation. Thank him for hosting me in the spiritual and historical centre



EAM S Jaishankar meets Bhutanese Foreign Minister Lyonpo DN Dhungyel during his official visit to Bhutan

of Bumthang,” Jaishankar posted on X.

“Our conversation focused on advancing our multifaceted engagement in development partnership, energy, trade, connectivity, culture and people-to-people

ties. Today’s discussions reflected the trust, goodwill and warmth of our ties,” he said.

EAM also inaugurated a couple of projects, including a 65-bed Gyaltsuen Jetsun Pema Mother and Child Hospital in Mongar.

CJP to launch ‘Adivasi School Thik Karo’ campaign from Gadchiroli: Dipke

OUR CORRESPONDENT  
Nagpur, September 16

Cockroach Janta Party founder Abhijeet Dipke on Wednesday alleged that tribal schools in India faced government apathy over the last 80 years, and announced the launch of his group’s ‘Adivasi School Thik Karo’ campaign from Gadchiroli in the state from September 17.

Addressing a press conference here, Dipke said the campaign is aimed at drawing the government’s

attention towards the problems and discrimination faced by tribal students.

A month back, the CJP launched the ‘School Thik Karo’ (Fix the Schools), a nationwide campaign aimed at improving the condition of rural and urban public schools.

Dipke said, “Schools in tribal regions across India have been neglected by all governments in the last 80 years. Therefore, we are starting the ‘Adivasi School Thik Karo’ campaign from Thursday in Gadchiroli dis-

trict of Maharashtra.”

As part of the exercise, CJP representatives will visit tribal schools and inspect the facilities and infrastructure, he said.

“Almost all governments have ignored tribal students...Political parties build their party headquarters in every district by spending crores of rupees, but they don’t have funds to give to tribal residential schools that are mostly operated from rented properties,” the CJP convenor said.

Briefs

MP: 4 women labourers buried alive

INDORE: Four women workers died and five others were injured when they were buried under debris while demolishing a dilapidated house in Indore district on Wednesday, a police official said.

Official said the accident occurred in Sanwer town, about 35 kilometres from the district headquarters, when work was underway to demolish a dilapidated house for reconstruction.

Biker, pillion-rider killed in collision

MORENA: A biker and a pillion rider were killed when a speeding car hit the two-wheeler in Morena district of Madhya Pradesh on Wednesday, police said. The accident occurred in the morning on Bhind Road when the two were travelling towards Porsa village on a motorcycle.

Ladakh L-G inaugurates Saras Mela

LEH: Lieutenant Governor V K Saxena on Wednesday called for taking products made by women self help groups (SHGs) in Ladakh to national and global markets, as he inaugurated the Saras Mela at Leh main market. He said the mela was not merely an exhibition but a celebration of the creativity and entrepreneurial spirit of Ladakh’s women.

Punjab to conduct civil defence air raid and blackout mock exercise

MPOST BUREAU  
Chandigarh, September 16

The Punjab government will conduct a Civil Defence Air Raid/Blackout Mock Exercise across all districts of the state on November 27 at 8 pm. The exercise is being conducted to test and strengthen Civil Defence preparedness across the State.

An official spokesperson informed that the mock exercise will begin with an Air Raid Warning Signal, which will be disseminated through sirens with a high-low pitch for two minutes. During the exercise, a simulated blackout will be enforced in the areas identified for the mock exercise by the respective Deputy Commissioners-Cum-Controllers, Civil Defence.

During the blackout, the general public in the identified areas will be required to switch off all

non-essential lighting. However, essential services will remain functional during the blackout.

Once the mock exercise is completed, an “All Clear” signal will be sounded through a continuous high-pitch siren for two minutes, indicating the termination of the exercise.

The spokesperson further said that the mock exercise will also simulate Fire Response Operations, Search and Rescue Operations, First-Aid and Medical Assistance, evacuation of injured persons and traffic and crowd control measures. These activities will help assess the preparedness and response mechanisms of the Civil Defence system.

The general public has been advised not to panic, as this is a routine drill being conducted to check Civil Defence preparedness.

Punjab also needs transparent, development-oriented govt: Saini

MPOST BUREAU  
Chandigarh, September 16

Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini, while addressing a public meeting organised at Goluka village in Ferozepur district of Punjab on Wednesday, said that Prime Minister Narendra Modi has given a new direction to the country and accelerated the pace of development.

From decisive action against terrorism to development and public welfare, the Central government has taken several important steps in the national interest.

He said that the ‘Seva Sankalp Abhiyan’ would begin across the country from September 17. To take forward the spirit of service and dedication of PM Modi among the people, everyone should light an ‘Ashirwad ka Diya’ at their homes between 6 pm and 7 pm on September 17 and pray for the long life of

‘EVEN TODAY, SOCIETY AND NATION NEED PATRIOTS WHO ARE DEDICATED TO WORKING FOR THE NATIONAL INTEREST, SOCIETY AND HUMANITY’

Prime Minister.

On the occasion, Saini paid tributes to Shaheed Udham Singh and said that the land of Punjab has given numerous brave sons who fought for the country’s Independence. The sacrifice of great revolutionaries like Shaheed Udham Singh will always be remembered by the nation. He said that even today, society and the nation need patriots who are dedicated to working for the national interest, society and humanity.

He also paid his respects to the parents of Shaheed Udham Singh.

The Chief Minister said

that he had the privilege of paying obeisance at Dera Baba Ram Thaman Ji Maharaj and receiving his blessings. The great tradition of Baba Ram Thaman Ji Maharaj has always carried forward the message of service, harmony and humanity.

The Chief Minister said that the people of Punjab are hardworking, talented and self-respecting. Referring to the development of Punjab, he said that the people of the state need a government that focuses on providing development and employment opportunities with transparency.

Meanwhile, addressing a programme organised by the Vishwa Sanatan Dharam Sabha in Chandigarh, CM Saini said that Sanatan is not merely a way of worship but an art of living life. Connecting oneself with service and public welfare is the essence of the Sanatan tradition.

NFR: Official Language Fortnight inaugurated



OUR CORRESPONDENT  
Malegaon, September 16

With the aim of promoting the increased use of Hindi and raising awareness about the Official Language within the Northeast Frontier Railway/Construction Organisation, ‘Rajbhasha Pakhwada-2026’ was inaugurated on September 15, 2026, in the distinguished presence of the General Manager/Construction, Ashish Bansal.

The programme commenced with the lighting of the ceremonial lamp by the General Manager (Construction).

“The state-of-the-art facility will strengthen access to quality, specialised maternal and child care in eastern Bhutan,” he posted on X.

Jaishankar also inaugurated the Jaganathan Bridge in Samdrup Jongkhar, built under Project Dantak.

“The Bhutan-India friendship project will improve connectivity between Trashigang and Samdrup Jongkhar in eastern Bhutan,” the EAM said.

He also laid the foundation stone for the 500 KW Lunana Hydropower Project in Gasa, northern Bhutan.

The Indian foreign minister also handed over 43 pureline Jersey cows to the National Cattle Breeding Centre in Bumthang to support the cattle breeding programme.

Ladakh: 20 NCC girl cadets completed 250-km trek

OUR CORRESPONDENT  
Leh, September 16

Twenty NCC girl cadets selected from across the country on Wednesday completed the 30-day, 250-km ‘Aparajita-Parang La 2026’ high-altitude long trek, traversing the 5,578-metre Parang La Pass connecting Himachal Pradesh’s Spiti Valley with Ladakh’s Changthang region.

The All India Girls High Altitude Long Trek, a flagship adventure activity of the National Cadet Corps (NCC), was flagged off at Karzok in Ladakh by Director General NCC Lieutenant General Virendra Vats and Additional Secretary, Ministry of Defence, Dipti Mohil Chawla, officials said.

The expedition covered challenging high-altitude terrain, including glaciers, snowfields and river valleys, they said.

The cadets, accompanied by NCC officers, instructors, medical staff and support personnel, completed the trek from Kibber in Himachal Pradesh to Karzok in Ladakh, they added.

The expedition was flagged off by Defence minister Rajnath Singh from New Delhi on August 18.

Congratulating the cadets and staff on the successful completion of the expedition, Vats said such activities contribute to developing leadership, self-confidence, teamwork and endurance among the youth.

The trek was organised to promote participation of young women in adventure activities and expose them to challenging high-altitude conditions.

THE WALKATHON AT UNA BEGAN FROM INDIRA STADIUM

No place for those selling chitta in Himachal: CM Sukhu

ASHWANI SHARMA  
Shimla, September 16

In a renewed public resolve to wipe out drugs from Himachal Pradesh, Chief Minister Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu on Thursday led a mass anti-chitta awareness walkathon at Una, a district bordering Punjab and declared a war against the drug mafia.

The chief minister said those trading drugs and sending youths to death have no place in society. Their only place is in jails. All their properties will be either confiscated or razed to the ground with no exception to anyone, big or small. Sukhu also appealed



CM Sukhu addresses the gathering at Una

to the people of Himachal Pradesh, especially the youth, to actively participate in the decisive fight against drugs and inform the police.

The walkathon at Una

began at Indira Stadium and proceeded towards the new bus stand and concluded at the stadium. A large number of students and common people across the district participated in the event

TAKEAWAYS

- » Sukhu also appealed to the people of Himachal Pradesh, especially the youth, to actively participate in the decisive fight against drugs and inform the police
- » A large number of students and common people across the district participated in the event with great enthusiasm

with great enthusiasm. Earlier, the Chief Minister administered the anti-chitta pledge to participants, urging them to remain vigilant and support the campaign against drugs.

He was joined by Deputy Chief Minister Mukesh Agnihotri, the state’s Advocate General Anoop Rattan, and several sitting and former MLAs.

Addressing the gathering, the Chief Minister said that the state government was taking firm and sustained action against the menace of drugs. However, he emphasised that government and police action alone cannot fully address the problem, and that active support and cooperation from every section of society are essential.

The Chief Minister said, ‘I want to clearly say from the land of Una that there

is no place in Himachal for those who sell chitta and destroy the lives of our youth for money. He said the government’s policy was clear and uncompromising when it comes to those involved in the illegal drug trade. Strict action would be taken against people selling chitta and those involved in drug trafficking, in accordance with the law.

At the same time, the government would adopt a compassionate approach towards young people who had already fallen into addiction and extend every possible support to help them recover and return to a normal life.

News at a glance

English village votes to leave UK over migrant housing plan

LONDON: A tiny English village has voted to leave the United Kingdom as a symbolic protest against government plans to house up to 1,200 asylum seekers on a nearby military base.

Residents of Piddington, which has a population of about 350, voted overwhelmingly for secession in the non-binding referendum. The results announced on Wednesday showed 285 votes in favour of breaking away. Protesters clashed with police last year outside hotels housing asylum seekers in London and several other cities.

EU chief calls for stronger, independent Europe

STRASBOURG: European Commission President Ursula von der Leyen on Wednesday called for a stronger and more independent Europe as she warned of an increasingly hostile world marked by Russia's war in Ukraine, conflicts in West Asia, economic competition with China, rising energy costs and growing threats to European security.

In her annual State of the European Union address to the European Parliament in Strasbourg, von der Leyen also referred to Europe's response to threats to Greenland.

WHO sees 'encouraging signs' in Congo Ebola fight

GENEVA: The head of the UN health agency is hailing "encouraging signs" in the fight against an Ebola outbreak in one part of eastern Congo, while warning that case counts are rising fast in another as officials race to tamp down the virus.

World Health Organisation Director-General Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus said signs of gaining ground against the Bundibugyo virus, the rare species behind the outbreak, have emerged in Ituri province, but added that the situation is one of "many outbreaks in many places."



A man offers dates he harvested to people passing by in Kafr Sendwah village, in Egypt's Galyubia AP/PTI

Gold mine collapse in Sudan kills at least 67

ASSOCIATED PRESS  
Cairo, September 16

A gold mine collapse in a remote area of Sudan has killed at least 67 people, a medical group and survivors said on Wednesday, the latest tragedy in a nation mired in a devastating war.

Survivors said the collapse happened at the al-Zara gold mine, in Nuhud, a town in West Kordofan province, which is controlled by the paramilitary Rapid Support Forces (RSF) that have been fighting against the Sudanese military for over three years.

IRAN-BACKED HOUTHIS DENY THE CLAIMS  
Saudi Arabia calls attempted attack on Mecca a 'red line'

ASSOCIATED PRESS  
Cairo, September 16

Saudi Arabia accused Yemen's Iran-backed Houthis rebels of trying to attack Islam's holiest city, as the region responded with condemnation Wednesday but no sign of military support. The kingdom, a key US ally, declared Mecca a "red line" as it slid deeper into the new front of the Iran war.

With the world's biggest oil exporter under fire from the rebels backed by the Saudis' regional adversary, the kingdom needs a safe outlet for its crude as well as military assistance. There's no clear



Representational Image

path to either. A crucial Saudi pipeline has been shut down, reportedly for weeks, after an attack by Iranian-backed militias in Iraq.

The Houthis have been targeting infrastructure in the kingdom and its shipping on the Red Sea, where they have seized several islands in the Bab el-Man-

HIGHLIGHTS

- » A crucial Saudi pipeline has been shut down
- » The Houthis have been targeting infrastructure in the kingdom
- » Turkey and Pakistan say the Saudis haven't asked for help

deb Strait.

And Iran is still targeting ships in the Strait of Hormuz. Oil prices remain above \$100 a barrel.

The Houthis denied firing drones toward Mecca, about 1,100 kilometres (680 miles) from Yemen's border.

Iran not interested in continuing conflict with US: Araghchi in China

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA  
Beijing, September 16

Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi on Wednesday said Tehran is not interested in continuing the conflict with the US and looks forward to returning to a diplomatic solution, as he held talks with his Chinese counterpart Wang Yi and briefed him on the latest developments in West Asia.

His visit to Beijing comes in the midst of an escalation of hostilities in West Asia following the military advances made by Yemen's Houthis, formally known as Ansar Allah.

The Iran-aligned Yemeni political and armed movement has stepped up attacks on Saudi Arabia and taken control of the strategic Bab el-Mandeb Strait in the Red Sea.



The Iran-US war has already restricted the movement of ships and oil tankers in the Strait of Hormuz, causing a widespread energy crisis.

Araghchi's visit also comes days after his well-publicised interactions with Wang and Russian Foreign Minister Sergei Lavrov on the sidelines of the BRICS

summit in New Delhi held from Sept 12-13. Araghchi accompanied Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian to the summit. This is Araghchi's fifth visit to China since 2024, reflecting the close ties between Tehran and Beijing.

During the meeting, Wang said both Iran and the US should return to the Islamabad Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) to end the conflict.

He said the continued prolongation of the US-Iran conflict is not in the common interest of the parties concerned and the international community, a read-out by the Chinese Foreign Ministry here said.

China encourages Iran and the US to stay rational and exercise restraint, return to the MoU at an early date, rebuild the negotiation mechanism.

भगवान विश्वकर्मा जयंती के अवसर पर

नमो श्रमिक सेवा केंद्र एवं  
गिग वर्कर्स विश्राम स्थल  
का शुभारंभ

मुख्य अतिथि

श्रीमती रेखा गुप्ता

माननीय मुख्यमंत्री, दिल्ली

विशिष्ट अतिथि

श्री कपिल मिश्रा

माननीय श्रम एवं रोजगार, कानून एवं न्याय, कला एवं संस्कृति, विकास, भाषा, पर्यटन मंत्री, दिल्ली सरकार

17 सितंबर 2026 | सुबह 09:30 बजे

दिल्ली सरकार अधिकारी आवासीय परिसर (टाइप IV फ्लैट्स), शालीमार बाग, हैदरपुर, दिल्ली



सत्यमेव जयते

दिल्ली सरकार



नरेन्द्र मोदी  
प्रधानमंत्री



रेखा गुप्ता  
मुख्यमंत्री, दिल्ली

दिल्ली भवन एवं अन्य निर्माण श्रमिक कल्याण बोर्ड  
राष्ट्रीय राजधानी क्षेत्र, दिल्ली सरकार

## News at a glance

## 'India's exports maintain strong growth in 2026-27'

**NEW DELHI:** India's exports remained on a strong growth trajectory in 2026-27 despite global headwinds, with cumulative merchandise and services exports during April-August estimated at USD 399.27 billion, up 15.55 per cent year-on-year, CII National Committee on Exports Chairman Sanjay Budhia said.

Merchandise exports rose 17.85 per cent to USD 215.91 billion, while non-petroleum exports increased 14.39 per cent to USD 180.61 billion. Services exports stood at USD 183.36 billion.

## BIS launches project to strengthen cotton testing

**NEW DELHI:** The Bureau of Indian Standards has launched a Rs 38.72-crore project to strengthen cotton fibre testing infrastructure.

Under the scheme to support laboratories in critical areas, the initiative aims to modernise 21 laboratories operated by the Textiles Committee, Power Loom Service Centres and Cotton Corporation of India. The project envisages 22 High Volume Instrument testers and 44 Trash Analysers. So far, 14 HVI testers and 28 Trash Analysers have been commissioned across 13 laboratories.

## Rupee slips 3 paise to 95.91 against US dollar

**MUMBAI:** The rupee stayed weak for the seventh consecutive session, declining 3 paise to 95.91 against the US dollar on Wednesday, tracking a strong greenback overseas and foreign fund outflows.

Forex traders said the rupee's slide was capped by positive domestic equity markets, even as crude oil prices remained elevated amid escalating US-Iran conflict. At the interbank foreign exchange market, the rupee opened at 95.89 and moved in the range of 95.85 to 95.98 against the greenback.

## RBI absorbs Rs 2.90 lakh cr via two VRRR auctions

**MUMBAI:** The Reserve Bank of India on Wednesday absorbed Rs 2.90 lakh crore from the banking system through two variable rate reverse repo auctions amid surplus liquidity.

It accepted Rs 2.50 lakh crore in the first auction at a weighted average rate of 5.24 per cent and Rs 40,302 crore in the second. Banking system liquidity stood at around Rs 9.85 lakh crore on September 15. The RBI has also announced Rs 1 lakh crore of open market sales of government securities in three tranches.

## 'COULD UNDO YEARS OF PROGRESS'

## MDR on UPI: Retailers warn of shift back to cash ahead of festive season

## OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 16

The Retailers Association of India (RAI) on Wednesday said the government's move to impose a 0.4 per cent Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) could reverse gains in digital payment adoption among small retailers ahead of the festive season.

On Tuesday, ending nearly six years of fully free UPI payments, the government introduced a 0.4 per cent fee on transfers worth more than Rs 2,000 made to merchants through the platform from October 15, while explicitly ring-fencing everyday person-to-person transactions as well as small payments from any charge.

The MDR, capped at Rs 300 for transactions of Rs 75,000 and above, keeps consumers outside its ambit but places the cost on merchants, many of whom operate on thin margins, RAI said.

"For MSME retailers already running on thin margins, burden creates a



## CLOSER LOOK

- » The govt introduced a 0.4% fee on transfers worth over Rs 2K made to merchants through the platform from Oct 15
- » For retailers running on thin margins burden creates a straightforward incentive to steer transactions back to cash

straightforward incentive to steer transactions back toward cash," it said.

RAI, in its statement warned that the charge "could undo years of progress in digital payment adoption" among India's smallest retailers, just as the festive season gets underway. "Small merchants will now think twice

about whether to accept cash or UPI," said RAI CEO Kumar Rajagopalan.

RAI said the shift back to cash would also hurt the government's own formalisation push, as transactions that move off the UPI network no longer feed into GST reporting, the opposite of what a decade of digitisation policy has

tried to build.

"This cuts against the government's own formalisation agenda. UPI acceptance should be incentivised, not taxed," Rajagopalan said.

The retail body, which claims to represent players ranging from large-format and specialty retail to e-commerce and quick commerce, also objected to treating all UPI transactions alike, arguing that most such payments draw directly from a savings or current account and function as digital debit transactions, without the interchange cost or credit risk that justifies charges on credit networks.

"We do not see the case for charging a bank-to-bank UPI payment the way you'd charge for credit. Where UPI is linked to a credit line, a fee is easier to defend, because the cost structure genuinely resembles a credit product," Rajagopalan said, adding that the government should bear the cost of normal UPI transactions since these generate GST

revenue and a traceable transaction trail.

RAI further argued that the cost of running the UPI network should not fall on merchants.

"NPCI keeps UPI running for the entire country, RBI or the government should be underwriting that cost, not merchants. The state gets a formal, traceable transaction it can tax out of every UPI payment. It should be paying for the enablement, not passing the bill down to the smallest retailer in the chain," Rajagopalan said.

The Clothing Manufacturers Association of India (CMAI) echoed similar concerns over the timing of the move.

"Introducing MDR on UPI at the start of the festive season could not have come at a more challenging time for the industry. This period is critical for merchants, retailers and consumer-facing businesses, many of whom are already working hard to revive demand and improve margins," said CMAI President Santosh Katariya.

## MPOST BUREAU

Mumbai, September 16

Market benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty rebounded on Wednesday on value buying after falling sharply in the previous session, with bank stocks driving the rally in equities.

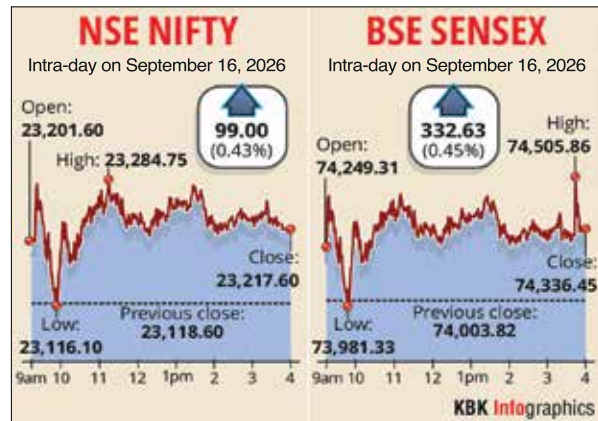
The 30-share BSE Sensex climbed 332.63 points, or 0.45 per cent, to settle at 74,336.45. During the day, it jumped 502.04 points, or 0.67 per cent, to 74,505.86.

The 50-share NSE Nifty was up 99 points, or 0.43 per cent, to end at 23,217.60. Among the 30 Sensex firms, ITC, State Bank of India, Axis Bank, Trent, Mahindra & Mahindra and Bharat Electronics were the major winners.

Tata Consultancy Services, Infosys, Tech Mahindra and Bajaj Finserv were among the laggards.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, dipped 0.83 per cent to USD 107.8 per barrel.

The BSE SmallCap Select index edged higher by 0.29 per cent and the MidCap Select index was up 0.26 per cent.



## BRENT CRUDE, THE GLOBAL OIL BENCHMARK, DIPPED 0.83% TO \$107.8 PER BARREL

Among the BSE sectoral indices, Insurance jumped 2.05 per cent, FMCG 1.44 per cent, PSU Bank 1.14 per cent, Realty 0.95 per cent, Top 10 Banks 0.83 per cent, Oil & Gas 0.77 per cent and Energy 0.73 per cent. Focused IT tanked 1.52 per cent, IT 1.42 per cent, Power 0.48 per cent, Housing Finance 0.37 per cent, Industrials 0.30 per cent and Hospitals 0.23 per cent.

In Asian markets, South

Korea's Kospi, Japan's Nikkei 225, Shanghai's SSE Composite index and Hong Kong's Hang Seng index ended in the positive territory.

Markets in Europe were trading higher. US markets ended lower on Tuesday. Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) offloaded equities worth Rs 2,977.86 crore on Tuesday, according to exchange data.

On Tuesday, the Sensex tumbled 777.94 points, or 1.04 per cent, to settle at a three-month low of 74,003.82. The Nifty dropped 279.50 points, or 1.19 per cent, to end at 23,118.60, the lowest closing level since April 6.

## NSE raises Rs 6,746 cr from anchor investors

## OUR CORRESPONDENT

Mumbai, September 16

The National Stock Exchange (NSE) on Wednesday garnered Rs 6,746 crore from anchor investors, including state-owned Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC), Goldman Sachs and Fidelity, ahead of the opening of its much-awaited IPO subscription.

Additionally, sovereign wealth funds GIC Singapore, Abu Dhabi Investment Authority (ADIA) and Norges Bank as well as Eastspring and HSBC Global Asset Management participated in the anchor round. According to a circular uploaded on the BSE website, NSE allotted over 3.77 crore shares to 150 anchor investors at Rs 1,785 apiece, the upper end of its IPO price band. This takes the transaction size to Rs 6,746.2 crore.

Foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) accounted for about 43 per cent of the anchor book, with investments of Rs 2,883 crore. More than 20 foreign long-only funds participated, with investors from the US, Europe and Asia spanning sovereign wealth funds, regional long-only funds and global mutual funds.

Domestic institutional participation was also broad-based, with the participation of mutual funds, insurance companies, pension funds and other institutions. More than 25 large domestic mutual funds

and 11 major insurance and pension companies invested around Rs 3,588 crore, accounting for 53 per cent of the anchor book.

The participating mutual funds included ICICI Prudential Mutual Fund, HDFC Mutual Fund, Nippon India Mutual Fund, Axis Mutual Fund, Aditya Birla Sun Life Mutual Fund, Kotak Mutual Fund, UTI Mutual Fund, Mirae Asset Mutual Fund, Tata Mutual Fund, Franklin Templeton, Edelweiss Mutual Fund and HSBC Mutual Fund.

LIC, NSE's largest shareholder with a 10.72 per cent stake, participated through three entities - LIC, LIC Mutual Fund and LIC Pension Fund - investing more than Rs 500 crore. NSE is among the top five holdings of LIC, whose existing stake in the exchange is larger than the portion being offered through the initial public offering (IPO).

The SBI group, which is selling a 1 per cent stake in NSE through State Bank of India and SBI Capital Markets, also participated in the anchor book through SBI Mutual Fund, SBI General Insurance, SBI Life Insurance and SBI Pension Fund, investing more than Rs 400 crore.

The strong institutional response comes ahead of NSE's Rs 22,569-crore IPO, for which the exchange has fixed a price band of Rs 1,700-1,785 per equity share.

## PM set to inaugurate SEMICON India 2026

Global companies, investors to attend 3-day conference & exhibition

## OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 16

Prime Minister Narendra Modi will on Thursday inaugurate SEMICON India 2026, a three-day conference and exhibition which will be attended by investors, researchers and start-ups from across the semiconductor and electronics value chain.

The conference and exhibition, to be held on the theme of "Silicon to Systems: Building the Ecosystem", will bring together global and Indian companies, policymakers, investors, researchers, start-ups, academic institutions and students from across the semi-



**THE CONFERENCE WILL FOCUS ON ADVANCING COLLABORATION, INVESTMENT, INNOVATION AND TALENT DEVELOPMENT IN INDIA**

conductor and electronics value chain, an official

statement said.

The conference will focus on advancing collaboration, investment, innovation and talent development in India. Parallel sessions will cover advancements in the display industry, six country roundtables designed to facilitate collaboration and joint ventures and a forum on women's leadership.

SEMICON India 2026 will adopt a comprehensive value-chain approach, showcasing the journey from semiconductor materials, equipment and chip design to fabrication, advanced packaging, electronics and systems.

The new "Sand to Silicon to Systems" Value

Chain Experience will present this journey across the semiconductor ecosystem.

SEMICON India 2026 will feature more than 600 participating companies and is expected to attract around 50,000 visitors, with representatives from 52 countries, more than 400 executives and over 150 speakers.

The exhibition will feature six country pavilions representing Japan, South Korea, Malaysia, the Netherlands, Singapore and Sweden, along with 12 state booths, a startup pavilion, innovation showcase, a student hackathon and a workforce development pavilion.

## AN EXPLAINER ON UPI FEE

## Why govt is charging for big payments

## MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, September 16

The government is putting a price for merchants using its flagship digital payment network to accept large transactions - a shift that follows years of warnings from the payment industry that the annual subsidy budgeted for the UPI never came close to covering the real cost of running it.

The NPCI, which operates the UPI network, said the revenue will support investment in infrastructure resilience, cybersecurity, fraud prevention,

**'THE ABSENCE OF AN MDR WAS MAKING UPI FINANCIALLY DIFFICULT TO SUSTAIN'**

innovation and customer service. "The MDR is distributed only amongst the UPI ecosystem, to further invest into infrastructure resilience, innovation, cybersecurity (protecting the UPI infrastructure with banks and non-banks) and customer service."

The move ends a zero-MDR regime that has been in place since January

2020, when the government scrapped merchant fees on UPI and RuPay debit card transactions to accelerate digital-payments adoption, compensating banks and fintechs instead through an annual budgetary incentive scheme. Since then, UPI has grown far beyond the scale envisaged. The network processed 2,451 crore transactions valued at Rs 29.9 lakh crore in August 2026. At that scale, the cost of keeping the system reliable, secure and capable of handling ever-higher volumes has also risen.

NPCI has said industry estimates put the annual cost of operating UPI - servers, bandwidth, fraud prevention and bank technical support - at roughly Rs 20,000 crore a year. The Department of Financial Services separately told Parliament's Standing Committee on Finance that the payments industry spends about Rs 20,700 crore annually on P2M transactions alone.

Also, a parliamentary committee report flagged that the absence of an MDR was making UPI financially difficult to sustain.

## CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE



**PNB Housing Finance MD & CEO Ajai Shukla, National Housing Bank MD Sanjay Shukla and Sikkim Social Welfare Department Secretary Sarika Pradhan during the inauguration of the company's first PMAY Nodal Branch in Eastern India at Siliguri**



**GOVERNMENT OF MANIPUR**  
**DEPARTMENT OF PERSONNEL & ADMINISTRATIVE REFORMS**  
**(Administrative Reforms Division)**

...

**NOTIFICATION**  
Imphal, the 16<sup>th</sup> September, 2026

**No ADM2-201/1/2026-AR-AR:** Applications are invited from eligible candidates for the appointment to the post of State Chief Information Commissioner as under:

| Sl. No. | Position                             | Number of Position |
|---------|--------------------------------------|--------------------|
| 1.      | State Chief Information Commissioner | 1 (one)            |

**2. A. Eligibility condition:**  
As provided under Section 15(5) and 15(6) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 as detailed below:

(i) The State Chief Information Commissioner shall be persons of eminence in the public life with wide knowledge and experience in law, science and technology, social service, management, journalism, mass media or administration and governance.

(ii) The State Chief Information Commissioner shall not be a Member of Parliament or Member of the Legislature of any State or Union Territory, as the case may be, or hold any other office of profit or connected with any political party or carrying on any business or pursuing any profession

**B. Other essential qualification:**

(i) The person should be a Citizen of India.

(ii) The person should not be of unsound mind, insolvent or convicted for any crime.

**3. Age:** Person who have attained the age of 65 years shall not be eligible for appointment.

**4. Terms of Office:**  
Under section 16 (1) of the RTI Act, 2005 read with Section 12 of the Right to Information Rules, 2019 (notified vide Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances & Pensions, Deptt. Of Personnel & Training No. G.S.R. 810 (E) dated 24th October, 2019):-

(i) The State Chief Information Commissioner shall hold office for a period of 3 (three) years from the date on which he enters upon his office.

Provided that no State Chief Information Commissioner shall hold office as such after he has attained the age of 65 (sixty-five) years.

**5. General conditions for Recruitment:**

(i) Candidates must fulfil the qualification and experience on the date of application. Education qualification must have been obtained from recognised University/Institute/Board/College only.

(ii) Selection/appointment will be subject to fulfilment of eligibility conditions, experiences etc., as also to verification of testimonials, antecedents and past service.

**6.** The salary, allowances and other terms and conditions of service of the State Chief Information Commissioner shall be as per the Right to Information Act, 2005 read with Right to Information (Term of office, Salaries, Allowances and Other Terms and Conditions of Service of State Chief Information Commissioner in the State Information Commission) Rules, 2019.

**7.** Persons fulfilling the criteria and interested for appointment to the above post may send their particulars in the prescribed Proforma, by post or by hand to Under Secretary (AR), Room No. 213, 3rd Floor, North Block, New Secretariat, Imphal West, Manipur-795002 or through e-mail to [darmanipur@gmail.com](mailto:darmanipur@gmail.com). Prescribed Proforma may be obtained from the office of the Section (AR), New Secretariat, 3rd Floor, North Block, Imphal West or download from the website [www.manipur.gov.in](http://www.manipur.gov.in).

Persons serving under the State/Central Government or any other Organisation, should send their particulars through proper channel (Administrative Ministry/Department of State- UT/Central Government or the Controlling Officer).

**8. Last date of receipt of application:** 5 p.m. of 15<sup>th</sup> October, 2026.

(K.H. Leiyaphy Rita)  
Joint Secretary (AR)  
Government of Manipur

DIPR No. 6/24/2024/DIPR Pt-1

**परिशिष्ट-1**  
**OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER,**  
**WATER WAYS DIVISION, HAZARIBAG.**

**e-Procurement Notice**  
e-Tender Reference No. :- DMFT/EE/WWD/HAZARIBAG/F2-03/2026 - 27  
Letter No. - 702  
Date :- 16.09.2026

|     |                                                         |                                                                                                                                |
|-----|---------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1.  | Name of Work                                            | Construction of 05 (Five) Additional Classroom in Project +2 High School, Rampur, Block - Chauparan, District - Hazaribag      |
| 2.  | Estimated Cost (In Rs.)                                 | Rs. 1,18,79,245.47                                                                                                             |
| 3.  | Time of Completion                                      | 12 Months                                                                                                                      |
| 4.  | Date of Publication of E-Tender on website              | 19.09.2026 at 1:00 P.M<br>(e-Procurement Portal- <a href="http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in">http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in</a> ) |
| 5.  | Last date/Time for Submission of E-Tender BID's         | 07.10.2026 up to 5:00 P.M                                                                                                      |
| 6.  | Last Date for Online Submission of E-Tender Fee and EMD | 07.10.2026 up to 5:00 P.M                                                                                                      |
| 7.  | Date of Opening Tender                                  | 09.10.2026 at 03:00 P.M                                                                                                        |
| 8.  | Name & address of office Inviting Tender                | Executive Engineer, Water Ways Division, Hazaribag,<br>9835739646 / 7004578862                                                 |
| 9.  | Contact No. of e-Procurement officer                    |                                                                                                                                |
| 10. | E-mail of e-Procurement officer                         | <a href="mailto:cewrhdzb@gmail.com">cewrhdzb@gmail.com</a>                                                                     |

**Note:-** 1.) Only e-Tender will be accepted.  
2.) Published Estimated Cost may be increased or decreased.  
3.) Further details can be seen and Mode of Submission of Online Tender/Tender Fee/EMD through <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in>

Executive Engineer  
Water Ways Division, Hazaribag.  
PR 389890 (Water Resource) 26-27 (D)

**PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON**  
See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Jagdish @ Divakar S/o Bhagwan Das R/o Gali No.6, Bihari Pur, Delhi & H. No. 3, Gali No.3, Bihar Pur Etnx, Opp. CRPF Camp, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide FIR No. 135/2025 U/S 25 Arms Act, PS Khajuri Khas, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused Jagdish @ Divakar can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said Jagdish @ Divakar has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused Jagdish @ Divakar of FIR No. 135/2025 U/S 25 Arms Act, PS Khajuri Khas, Delhi is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of 09.12.2026.

By Order,  
Ms. Norma Jain  
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03  
Room No. 22, First Floor, North-East District  
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/13082/NE/2026(Court Matter)

**NORTHERN RAILWAY**  
**TENDER NOTICE**

The Dy. Chief Engineer/Const., Northern Railway, State Entry Road-II, New Delhi for and on behalf of President of India invites open e-tender under One Packet System for the under noted work:-

|                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                |
|---------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1) Full Name                                            | Ghaziabad Work for modernization upgradation & renovation of Electric of work Training Centre, Ghaziabad into multi-disciplinary training Centre".             |
| 2) Approx. cost:                                        | Rs. 797.07 Lakhs                                                                                                                                               |
| 3) Completion period:                                   | 12 (Twelve) months                                                                                                                                             |
| 4) Bid Security (Cash/BG) amount                        | Rs. 15,94,200/- (Rupees Fifteen Lakh Ninety-Four Thousand Two Hundred Only.)                                                                                   |
| 5) Sale/availability of tender document on Rly. website | Tender documents will be available on IREPS web site i.e. <a href="http://www.ireps.gov.in">www.ireps.gov.in</a> from 16.09.2026 to 07.10.2026 upto 15.00 hrs. |
| 6) Last date/Time of upload of tenders                  | 07.10.2026 upto 15.00 hours. Tender documents can be uploaded by the tenderer on IREPS web site w.e.f. 23.09.2026 to 07.10.2026                                |
| 7) Date and time of opening of tender                   | 07.10.2026 at 15.00 hours                                                                                                                                      |

No. 85-Acs-ETG-CBZ-SER-II, Date : 16.09.2026 3206/26

**SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE**

**NORTHERN RAILWAY**  
**TENDER NOTICE**

Invitation of tender through E-Tendering (E-Procurement Systems)

| S. No. | Name of work with its location                                                                                                                                            | Approx. Cost of work | EMD amount      | Completion Period of work |
|--------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|-----------------|---------------------------|
| (A)    | Repair to vacant flats of college lane, Tilak Bridge Railway Colony in the S/o SSE/W/BH under ADEN/E-III.                                                                 | Rs. 1,49,99,740.17   | Rs. 3,00,000.00 | 06 Months                 |
| (B)    | Annual General repair, White wash & Painting of Type-I, II, V flats at College lane and Tilak Bridge and service building in colony in the S/o SSE/W/BH under ADEN/E-III. | Rs. 1,49,99,562.75   | Rs. 3,00,000.00 | 12 Months                 |
| (C)    | Annual General repair, White wash & Painting of Type-I, II, IV, VI flats at Anand Vihar Railway Colony in the S/o SSE/W/BH under ADEN/E-III.                              | Rs. 1,34,99,694.98   | Rs. 2,70,000.00 | 12 Months                 |

Date and Time for Opening & Closing date of tender on 08.10.2026 at 15:00 hrs.

Website particular notice board location complete details of tender can be seen and address of the office from where the tender form can be purchased etc.

Above tender available on website i.e. <http://www.ireps.gov.in>

No: 128-W/269/O.E./T/NIT No. 16 (A, B, C)/26-27/WE/ Dated:- 10.09.2026 3199/2026

**SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE**

**UJVN LIMITED**  
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006  
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508  
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: [www.ujvn.com](http://www.ujvn.com)

**Tender Notice**  
Letter No: 820 Date: 16/09/2026  
Office of the Executive Engineer (Generation), Khodri Power Station, Dakpathar (Dehradun), invites sealed tenders from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:  
**Tender No: 13/EE(Gen)/Khodri/2026-27: Annual Preventive Maintenance of Generator of Unit No. 1 at Khodri Power Station**  
Estimated cost: Rs. 12.43,095/- GST extra  
Date of availability of bid document on website: 17.09.2026, 10:00 hrs.  
Last date for submission of tender: 08.10.2026 up to 16:00 hrs.  
For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website "www.ujvn.com"  
Executive Engineer (Generation)

**"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"**

**BEFORE DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL-II, DELHI**  
4<sup>th</sup> Floor, Jeevan Tara Building, Parliament Street, New Delhi-110001  
Notice under section 19(4) of the Recovery of Debts Due to Bank and Financial Institutions Act 1993 read with rule 12 & 13 of the Debts Recovery Tribunal (Procedure) Rule, 1993 in the matter of  
OA No 889/2024  
IBBI/BANK/LTD. DATE: 07.05.2026  
APPLICANT  
SH. BHANU PRATAP NARAYAN PANDEY & ORS. RESPONDENT  
To, DEFENDANT  
D1. SH BHANU PRATAP NARAYAN PANDEY SO SH SHIV NATH PANDEY, 15 NAYAPURA NEW CENTRAL JAIL KARONI HUZUR BHOPAL MADHYA PRADESH-462036  
ALSO AT F-46 2ND FLOOR NEAR GATE NO 8 SECT 20 NOIDA UP 201301  
ALSO AT FLAT NO AM-A 1806 ON 18TH FLOOR TOWER-AAJNARAMBROSIA PLOT NO GH-01 SECT 118 NOIDA 201306  
ALSO AT ROYAL SOTFTECH INDIA PVT.LTD, 8-28 GROUND FLOOR SECT 1 NOIDA UP  
D2. MS AJNARA INDIA LTD, D-247/26 SECT 63 NOIDA UP ALSO AT 502 SACHDEVIA CORPORATE TOWER KARKARDOOMA COMMUNITY CENTRE DELHI-92  
Whereas the above named applicant (s) has / have instituted a case for recovery of Rs. 58,05,072/- (RUPEE FIFTY EIGHT LAKH FIVE THOUSAND SEVENTY TWO ONLY) against you and where as it has been shown to the satisfaction of the Tribunal that it is not possible to serve you in the ordinary way therefore, this notice is given by advertisement directing you to make appearance in the Tribunal on 22.09.2026 At 11.00 A.M. Take notice that in default of your appearance on the day before mentioned, the case will be heard and determined in your absence.  
All the matters will be taken up through video Conferencing or physical and for that Purpose:-  
(i) All the Advocates/Litigants shall download the "Cisco Webex" applications/software; (ii) "Meeting ID" and Password for the date of hearing qua cases to be taken by Honble Presiding Officer/Registrar shall be displayed in the daily cause list itself at DRT Official Portal i.e. [drt.gov.in](http://drt.gov.in) (iii) In any exigency qua that the Advocate/Litigants can contact the concerned official at Ph. No. 23748478.  
Given under my hand and seal of the Tribunal this 07<sup>th</sup> day of May, 2026.  
BY ORDER OF THE TRIBUNAL, SECTION OFFICER, DRT-II, DELHI.

**UJVN LIMITED**  
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006  
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508  
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: [www.ujvn.com](http://www.ujvn.com)

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**  
**E-Tendering Tender Notice**

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer (Traction Distribution) N.C. Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites Sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.

| E-Tender No.          | Approx Cost    | Earnest Money/Bid Security |
|-----------------------|----------------|----------------------------|
| JHS-TD-TENDER-2026-13 | Rs.: 819855.60 | Rs.: 16400.00              |

**Description of Work :** OHE Modification work in connection of construction of RUB in between KM 1173/5-7 of MCSC-DAYG section in LAR-KURJ-MBA section of Jhansi division

**Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter : 09 Months**

**Date of closing Tender : 05.10.2026, 15:00 pm.**

| E-Tender No.          | Approx Cost     | Earnest Money/Bid Security |
|-----------------------|-----------------|----------------------------|
| JHS-TD-TENDER-2026-14 | Rs.: 1296575.82 | Rs.: 25900.00              |

**Description of Work :** OHE Modification in connection of Necessary alteration in line no.6 (PF-4 line) for making through 3rd line and provision of OHE at new line (PF-5 line) at Gwalior yard

**Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter : 09 Months**

**Date of closing Tender : 05.10.2026, 15:00 pm.**

| E-Tender No.          | Approx Cost      | Earnest Money/Bid Security |
|-----------------------|------------------|----------------------------|
| JHS-TD-TENDER-2026-15 | Rs.: 18908950.40 | Rs.: 378200.00             |

**Description of Work :** OHE Modification in connection of Necessary alteration in line no.6 (PF-4 line) for making through 3rd line and provision of OHE at new line (PF-5 line) at Gwalior yard

**Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter : 09 Months**

**Date of closing Tender : 05.10.2026, 15:00 pm.**

Tender online can be submitted up to 15:00 hrs on 05.10.2026. \* For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website [www.ireps.gov.in](http://www.ireps.gov.in) 2088/26 (D)

[www.northcentralrailways.gov.in](http://www.northcentralrailways.gov.in) @ [www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in](mailto:www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in) @ [CPRONCR](mailto:CPRONCR)

**PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON**  
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person, namely, Ashif Ansari, S/o, Anwar Ansari, R/o: Flat No.99, G-Block, Jahangir Puri, Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in FIR No.: 509/18 U/s.: 392/411 IPC, registered at P.S.: Jahangir Puri, Delhi and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, Ashif Ansari cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, Ashif Ansari have absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said, accused person, Ashif Ansari, FIR No.: 509/18 U/s. 392/411 IPC, registered at P.S.: Jahangir Puri, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 23.10.2026.

By Order  
Sh. Sahil Gupta  
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07  
North Court No. 06, Ground Floor  
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/13115/NW/2026  
(Court Matter)

**PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON**  
See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused Naveen Malhotra, R/o.: B-24, Kailash Colony, New Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide FIR No.113/2015 Dt.12.03.2015 U/S 406/420/468/471/120B IPC registered at P.S. Defence Colony, Economic Offences Wing, New Delhi and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest there upon issued stating that the said accused Naveen Malhotra could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused Naveen Malhotra is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said Naveen Malhotra, accused of FIR No. 113/2015 Dt.12.03.2015 U/S 406/420/468/471/120B IPC, P.S. Defence Colony, Economic Offences Wing, New Delhi is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before 04.12.2026.

By Order, Sh. Abhinav Pandey  
Chief Judicial Magistrate,  
South East District,  
Saket Court Complex, New Delhi

DP/13124/EOW/2026  
(Court Matter)

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**  
**E-Tender Notice**

Senior Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer / Coordination / North Central Railway/ Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite E-TENDER on prescribed form for the following works up to 12.00 hrs. on the opening date of E-tender mentioned therein. The details of the Tender are as under:-

**Tender No.:** 038. **Name of work:** Comprehensive Annual Maintenance Contract for Fire Alarm System (Vignaharta Make) installed at various locations (Stations / Relay Huts) over Prayagraj Division for a period of Two Years.

**Approx Cost of work :** ₹ 3,03,50,940.48 **Earnest Money :** ₹ 6,07,000/-

**Cost of Tender Form:** ₹ 0.00 **Completion Period :** 24 Months

**Date of Opening of tender:** 13.10.2026

**Validity of offer :** 60 days from the date of opening

**Availability of tender form:** Tender forms are available on [www.ireps.gov.in](http://www.ireps.gov.in)

**Earnest Money to be deposited:** The prescribed amount of Bid Security as mentioned above must be deposited along with the tender form Online through Internet Banking or Online Payment gateway only. The tenderer(s) should note that, in any case, the Bid Security in any other form than specified in GCC shall be acceptable. If the Bid Security deposited by the bidder is in shape of Bank Guarantee, it should be supported by proper stamp duty, rate prescribed as per section 13 & 24 of the UP Stamp Act, 2008 and amended from time to time at the time of submission of Bank Guarantee. Tenders without Bid Security shall be summarily rejected.

**Time & place of opening of tender:** Tender will be opened through E-Tender at office of Divisional Railway Manager, Prayagraj at or after 12.30 hrs. In case tender opening date happens to be holiday, Tenders will be opened on the next working day.

**Right of Railway to deal with tender:** Railway administration reserves the rights to postpone/modify or to cancel the tender without assigning any reasons. 2117/26 (MG)

[www.northcentralrailways.gov.in](http://www.northcentralrailways.gov.in) @ [CPRONCR](mailto:CPRONCR) @ [www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in](http://www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in)

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**  
**E-Procurement Tender Notice : 15/2026**  
**E-Procurement Tender Notice**

**Tender No.:** 13266080 **Qty :** 593031 Nos

**Description :** COMPOSITE GROOVED RUBBER SOLE PLATE (CGRSP).

**EMD (Rs.) :** 1118220/- **Tender Opening Date :** 12.10.26

**Note :** (1) The complete information of above E-Procurement Tender are available on IREPS website i.e. <http://www.ireps.gov.in>. (2) Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above Tender. For this purpose, Vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with class III digital signature certificates issued by CCA under IT Act-2000. (3) Rates entered into financial rate page and duly signed digitally shall only be considered. Rates and any other financial entity in any other form/letter head if attached by vendor shall be straight away ignored and shall not be considered. (4) Documents being attached should be signed on their body. (5) Allocation for "Cost of Drawing" is ₹ 2-650 and for "Earnest Money deposit (EMD)" is Deposit Misc. stores-00844517. In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the IREPS website may be approached. 2111/26 (C)

[www.northcentralrailways.gov.in](http://www.northcentralrailways.gov.in) @ [CPRONCR](mailto:CPRONCR) @ [www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in](http://www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in)

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**  
**E-Procurement Tender Notice No. : 14/2026**  
**E-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE**

**Tender No.:** 13266111 **E.M.D. (Rs.):** ₹ 1336480/-

**Description:** ELASTIC RAIL CLIP (ERC) MK-V

**Qty:** 590840 Nos. **Tender Opening Date:** 05.10.2026

**Note:-** (1) The complete information of above E-Procurement Tender are available on IREPS website i.e. <http://www.ireps.gov.in>. (2) Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against Above Tender, for this purpose, Vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Class III Digital Signature certificates issued by CCA under IT Act-2000. (3) Rates entered into financial rate page and duly signed digitally shall only be considered. Rates and any other financial entity in any other form/letter head if attached by vendor shall be straight away ignored and shall not be considered. (4) Documents being attached should be signed on their body. (5) Allocation for "Cost of Drawing" is ₹ 2-650 and for "Earnest Money deposit (EMD)" is Deposit Misc. stores-00844517. In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the IREPS website may be approached. 2107/26 (A)

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**PUBLIC NOTICE**

Transfer of ownership in respect of residential H.No. FCA-1664, Block-A, Gali No.4, SGM Nagar, Faridabad, Haryana, Late Sh. Roop Singh S/o Late Sh. Kartar Singh owner of the subject cited property as per record and had died on 29.10.2012. Late Sh. Roop Singh had not executed any will during his lifetime, leaving behind: Sukhwant Kaur (Wife), Iqbaljit Singh (son) as legal heirs.

If any person, legal heir or institution etc. has any objection regarding transfer of the said property in the name of above said legal heirs, respectively, he/she may submit the objection within 30 days from the date of publication of this notice before the ZTO/Commissioner/ Joint Commissioner, Municipal Corporation, Faridabad, in writing along with relevant documents. If no objection is received from anyone within this period, then this property will be transferred in the name of above said legal heirs.

Commissioner  
Municipal Corporation, Faridabad

**PUBLIC NOTICE**

Transfer of ownership in respect of residential H.No. FCA-1664, Block-A, Gali No.4, SGM Nagar, Faridabad, Haryana, Late Sh. Pargat Singh S/o Late Sh. Sant Singh owner of the subject cited property as per record and had died on 05.09.2004. Late Sh. Pargat Singh had not executed any will during his lifetime, leaving behind: Rajwant Kaur (wife), Gupreet Singh (son), Manpreet Kaur (daughter), Baljinder Gandhi (daughter) as legal heirs.

If any person, legal heir or institution etc. has any objection regarding transfer of the said property in the name of above said legal heirs, respectively, he/she may submit the objection within 30 days from the date of publication of this notice before the ZTO/Commissioner/ Joint Commissioner, Municipal Corporation, Faridabad, in writing along with relevant documents. If no objection is received from anyone within this period, then this property will be transferred in the name of above said legal heirs.

Commissioner  
Municipal Corporation, Faridabad

**PUBLIC NOTICE**

Transfer of ownership in respect of residential H.No. FCA-1664, Block-A, Gali No.4, SGM Nagar, Faridabad, Haryana, Late Sh. Satnam Singh S/o Late Sh. Sangat Singh owner of the subject cited property as per record and had died on 06.04.2024. Late Sh. Satnam Singh had not executed any will during his lifetime, leaving behind: Gurmeet Kaur (wife), Inderjeet Singh (son), Manjinder Kaur (daughter), Baljinder Gandhi (daughter) as legal heirs.

If any person, legal heir or institution etc. has any objection regarding transfer of the said property in the name of above said legal heirs, respectively, he/she may submit the objection within 30 days from the date of publication of this notice before the ZTO/Commissioner/ Joint Commissioner, Municipal Corporation, Faridabad, in writing along with relevant documents. If no objection is received from anyone within this period, then this property will be transferred in the name of above said legal heirs.

Commissioner  
Municipal Corporation, Faridabad

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**  
**E-TENDERING TENDER NOTICE**

Tender Notice No.: 7420262027 Date: 10.09.2026

Sr. DEN/Co./North Central Railway, Prayagraj for and on behalf of the President of India, invites online open tenders (Composite E-tender, Two Packet System) as detailed below-

**E-Tender Notice No.:** 7420262027-158

**Name of work:** Construction of multi storey building (G+6) for trainee Hostel at IRMTTC - Subedarganj including Fire fighting, Plumbing services & Electrical works under Prayagraj Division, North Central Railway

**Approx Cost (In Rs.):** ₹ 33,33,10,135.42 **Earnest Money (In Rs.):** ₹ 66,66,200.00

**Date & Time of Closing of tender:** 05.10.2026 at 15:00 PM

**Completion period:** 18 Months.

**Note:-** 1. For full details and submission of tenders, please see the Indian Railway website [www.ireps.gov.in](http://www.ireps.gov.in). 2. Tender offer shall be made online through Two Packet System i.e. (i) Technical Bid (ii) Financial Bid. 2089/26 (PH)

[www.northcentralrailways.gov.in](http://www.northcentralrailways.gov.in) @ [CPRONCR](mailto:CPRONCR) @ [www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in](http://www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in)

**PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON**  
(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused Mukesh Kumar S/o Valister R/o A-50, F-Block, Gali No. 1, Som Bazar Road, Inder Enclave, Kirari, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in FIR No. 504/2023 U/s 498A/406/304 IPC, PS Prem Nagar, Delhi and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused Mukesh Kumar cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Mukesh Kumar has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that Mukesh Kumar in FIR No. 504/2023 U/s 498A/406/304 IPC, PS Prem Nagar, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 06.11.2026.

By order  
Sh. Sachin Mittal  
Additional Sessions Judge-05  
Room No. 217, 2nd Floor  
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/1307/RD/2026

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**  
**E-Tender Notice**

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering)/North Central Railway/ Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites the following E-Tenders on prescribed form for the following work up to 13:30 hrs. on 05.10.2026. The details of the tender are as under:-

| S N | Tender No. | Approx. Cost of work (Rs.) | Bid Security (Rs.) |
|-----|------------|----------------------------|--------------------|
| 1   | 159        | 10234048.45                | 204700.00          |
| 2   | 160        | 6498977.14                 | 130000.00          |
| 3   | 161        | 10126811.72                | 202500.00          |
| 4   | 162        | 35344975.50                | 706900.00          |
| 5   | 163        | 47422405.83                | 948500.00          |
| 6   | 164        | 43472181.96                | 869500.00          |

**Name of work:** Construction of 15 units Type-II quarters & 02 units Type-III quarters in lieu of abandoned quarters and construction of rain water harvesting under ADEN/FZD.

**Name of work:** Construction of 16 units Type-II quarters in lieu of abandoned quarters and construction of rain water harvesting under ADEN/ETW.

**Completion period:** For SN. 1 to 6- 12 months. **Date of Opening of tender:** For SN. 1 to 6- 05.10.2026. **Similar work for Eligibility Criteria:** For SN. 1, 2 & 4- Any Civil Engineering Work. For SN. 3- Construction of Building. For SN. 5- (A) Construction of Building (For Civil component of value = Rs. 4,03,09,159.15) (B) Satisfactory execution of any electrical work related to HT/LT installation (For Electrical component of value = Rs. 71,13,246.68), For SN. 6- (A) Construction of Building (For Civil component of value = Rs. 3,74,86,403.13) (B) Satisfactory execution of any electrical work related to HT/LT installation (For Electrical component of value = Rs. 59,85,778.83).

**Note:-** (1) The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders is available on website [www.ireps.gov.in](http://www.ireps.gov.in) up to 13:30 hrs. on the due date of tender opening i.e. 05.10.2026. The tender shall be opened at or after 15:00 hrs on due date of opening. (2) Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above Tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Digital Signature Certificates issued by CCA under IT Act-2000 (3) Rates entered into Financial Rate page and duly signed digitally shall only be considered. Rates and any other financial entity in any other form/letter head if attached by vendors shall be straightaway ignored and shall not be considered. (4) Tender Nos. 159 to 164 are having advertised value more than 50 Lakhs, therefore, Annexure-V & V(A) (Document Verification Certificate) is required. The supplier / contractor of goods and / or services would be subject to GST Act and Rules as applicable from time to time. (5) This tender notice has also been uploaded on [www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in](http://www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in) (6) In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached. (7) Tender online can be submitted up to 13:30 hrs. on 05.10.2026. (8) E-Tender Forms shall be issued free of cost to all tenderers. (9) For tender nos. 159 to 164: The tenderers have to submit necessary documents in compliance of clause 10 to 18 (Part-I) of IRGCC-2022 (Works matter) mandatorily, otherwise their offer will be considered as incomplete Offer and accordingly shall not be considered. 2105/26 (PH)

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ABHISHEK BANERJEE ON SUCCESS OF 'MIRZAPUR: THE MOVIE'

'ANYONE CAN FLIP BETWEEN BOLLYWOOD & OTT'

The film has earned over Rs 250 crore at the box office

Abhishek Banerjee believes that 'Mirzapur: The Movie' hasn't only attained massive success at the box office but also shown that there's no dividing line between mainstream Bollywood artists and OTT performers.



OTT platform. "I remember casting for 'Mirzapur' and I remember how difficult it was at that time to communicate to some of the actors that this can be the next big thing. I used to say, 'Just read the script. If you don't like the script, say no'. Many actors used to say, 'I'm not an actor to be seen on a laptop' and now everybody wants to be a part of a good web show," said Banerjee, also known for his performances in series 'Paatal Lok' and horror comedy franchise 'Stree'.

Munna Tripathi. "I was actually bored with the whole idea of people from the industry putting these tags about OTT and Bollywood actors and this and that. I hope that people are observing and understanding that there is no boundary and anybody can flip any side," he told PTI. The actor, who also served as a casting director on 'Mirzapur' series, recalled having 'difficulty' in roping in actors for the

'Film industry stops us from making good art'

Every film is a struggle, said filmmaker Tigmanshu Dhulia, who believes that those in the industry who greenlight projects have 'zero vision' and stop storytellers from exploring good work on screen. Known for films such as 'Haasil', 'Paan Singh Tomar' and 'Saheb Biwi Aur Gangster' and OTT shows like 'Criminal Justice' and 'The Great Indian Murder' and 'Garmi', Dhulia questioned the industry's obsession with formula films despite its inconsistent results.



"Every film is a struggle. If you want to tell a story in a different way, this industry stops us from making good art. The people who greenlit projects here have zero vision. So, you are cursed. If you are making films in India, you'll always be stopped from doing good work. You won't be allowed to do it," Dhulia told PTI.

FILMMAKER TIGMANSHU DHULIA SAID 'EVERY FILM IS A STRUGGLE' NOW

He added, "What's their ratio (producers)? They have a higher ratio of flops. Despite following the rule, they are still failing." The director's latest film 'Ghamasaan', starring Arshad Warsi, Pratik Gandhi and Rajpal Yadav, is currently streaming on 'ZEE5'. The 59-year-old filmmaker, who is also known for his acting work in movies such as 'Gangs of Wasseypur' and 'Zero', said 'Ghamasaan' is a commercial film, yet it faced challenges in its release. Dhulia said it 'hurts a lot' that the film, which was originally intended for the big screen, could only be released on OTT.

'The Diplomat' season four trailer out

Streaming service 'Netflix' released the official trailer for the fourth season of its political drama series 'The Diplomat', which will premiere on October 15. The new season will continue to follow US Ambassador Kate Wyler, played by Keri Russell and her husband, Vice President Hal Wyler (Rufus Sewell), as their professional and personal lives become increasingly entangled.



THE TRAILER HINTS AT FRESH POLITICAL CONSPIRACIES AND FURTHER STRAIN IN THE COUPLE'S MARRIAGE

before Kate began to suspect that her husband and Grace had kept her in the dark about their plans.

Series creator, showrunner and executive producer Debora Cahn said the fourth season centres on Kate, Hal and Grace as well as First Gentleman Todd Penn (Bradley Whitford).

"This season is built on the foursome that is Kate, Hal, Grace and Todd," Cahn told Netflix's fan website 'Tudum'. "They're two couples strapped together in one car on a crumbling roller coaster. Each of them has a professional, public role that's upending their ability to function as a married person."

Amitabh Bachchan slams retirement rumours

Bollywood megastar Amitabh Bachchan said one of his recent posts was misinterpreted and confirmed he has no plans to retire. The actor shared a note on his blog earlier this week, which had 'it's late, time to retire' written and was misunderstood by some. Bachchan attached a newspaper clipping with the retirement news on it as he shared another note on Monday and called out the false reports. "I wrote in the blog, 'It's late, time to retire...' which we all know means retire to bed; it's late and this is the media - the CONSCIENCE of a NATION - THE ULTIMATE INFORMER," he said. "No sir, I am not retiring from work any time soon; (retire) in English means going to sleep. And you are not invited there," he added.



THE VETERAN ACTOR WILL NEXT FEATURE IN 'SECTION 84'

The actor will next feature in 'Section 84'. The film is directed by Ribhu Dasgupta and also features Nimrat Kaur and others. He will also appear in 'Kalki 2', which is a sequel to 'Kalki 2898 AD'. He will reprise the role of Ashwatthama in the film.

ED SHEERAN'S TOUR IN TROUBLE AFTER OPENING ACTS DROP OUT

The moves by his fellow artists put enormous pressure on him, who has tried to avoid politics

Ed Sheeran's tour of North and South America fell into chaos when four of his supporting acts abruptly quit in solidarity with rapper Macklemore, who was dropped for making pro-Palestinian comments onstage.



Hours after Sheeran posted on social media on Tuesday about Macklemore's ouster and attributed the decision to the tour's promoters, Irish acts Aaron Rowe and Beoga, the Danish band Lukas Graham and Finneas posted on 'Instagram' that they were leaving the tour.

Rowe and Lukas Graham would have been replacements for Macklemore on Sheeran's remaining US dates, while Beoga had been performing several songs - including some the Irish folk band co-wrote - with Sheeran around the middle of each set.

Finneas, who is Billie Eilish's brother and musical collaborator, was due to tour with Sheeran in South America later this year. "Artists must not be silenced when they speak up for the oppressed," Finneas said on Instagram. "I have decided to withdraw from my upcoming tour dates with Ed Sheeran. I stand with Palestine and its people."

The moves by his fellow artists put enormous pressure on Sheeran, who has tried to avoid politics and taking a side in the Gaza conflict, arguing that his fans don't come to his shows to hear politics. Rowe and Beoga each cited their country's history in their statements explaining their decision.

Rashmika to essay M S Subbulakshmi in her biopic

The legendary Indian classical vocalist was known for Carnatic music

Rashmika Mandanna is set to essay the role of a legendary Indian classical vocalist, M S Subbulakshmi, in her biopic. Subbulakshmi was known for Carnatic music, a traditional style of South Indian classical music. She was also the first musician to receive the Bharat Ratna, India's highest civilian honour. The film is directed by Gowtam Tinnanuri and is produced by Allu Aravind ('Geetha Arts'), Rockline Venkatesh ('Rockline Entertainment') and Bunny Vasu ('Bunny Vas Works'). Composer Anirudh Ravichander is composing the music for the film.



SUBBULAKSHMI WAS ALSO THE FIRST MUSICIAN TO RECEIVE THE BHARAT RATNA, INDIA'S HIGHEST CIVILIAN HONOUR

The official launch of the film took place in Chennai on Subbulakshmi's 110th birth anniversary, where Kamal Haasan was the chief guest at the event.

The production banner shared the announcement with a post on the official 'X' handle, which featured the portrait of the late singer. "A LEGACY begins with an unforgettable celebration. Witness the grand launch of #MS - A Legacy on screen, celebrating Bharat Ratna #MSSubbulakshmi Amma's 110th Birth Anniversary with Ulaganaya-

gan @ikamalhaasan garu as Chief Guest," read the caption.

Mandanna will next feature in 'Ranabaali' alongside Vijay Deverakonda. The film is directed by Rahul Sankrityan and is described as a period action drama set against the backdrop of 19th-century British colonial rule.



FOUR OF HIS SUPPORTING ACTS ABRUPTLY QUIT IN SOLIDARITY WITH RAPPER MACKLEMORE, WHO WAS DROPPED FOR MAKING PRO-PALESTINIAN COMMENTS ONSTAGE

INDIA SQUAD FOR WEST INDIES ODIS

Hardik, Pant ignored as Dhir, Nabi get maiden call-ups

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA  
New Delhi, September 16

Rookie Punjab all-rounder Naman Dhir and Jammu and Kashmir seamer Auqib Nabi earned their maiden call-ups to India's ODI squad for the upcoming series against the West Indies, while veterans Hardik Pandya and Rishabh Pant were ignored for separate reasons.

The PTI had reported that KL Rahul will be the vice-captain in absence of Shreyas Iyer.

India will play three ODIs and five T20Is against the West Indies starting September 27 in Thiruvananthapuram.

The T20I side will comprise mostly the Asian Games squad with Mayank Yadav and Prince Yadav coming in place of Yash Thakur and Vipraj Nigam.

Meanwhile, after the Asian Games Jasprit Bumrah will directly play ODIs in New Zealand.

**Jadeja earns a recall**  
While Ravindra Jadeja's white ball stocks are on the wane, Axar Patel's presence in the Asian Games squad and Harsh Dubey's untimely hamstring injury



Rookie Punjab all-rounder Naman Dhir



Jammu and Kashmir seamer Auqib Nabi

HIGHLIGHTS

» The PTI had reported that KL Rahul will be the vice-captain in absence of Shreyas Iyer

» The T20I side will comprise mostly the Asian Games squad with Mayank Yadav and Prince Yadav coming in place of Yash Thakur and Vipraj Nigam

Case of Pandya and Pant

**INDIA'S ODI TEAM:** Shubman Gill (C), Rohit Sharma, Virat Kohli, Ruturaj Gaikwad, KL Rahul (VC), Dhruv Jurel, Nitish Kumar Reddy, Ravindra Jadeja, Kuldeep Yadav, Prasidh Krishna, Gurnoor Brar, Mohammed Siraj, Auqib Nabi, Yashasvi Jaiswal, Naman Dhir.

**INDIA'S T20I TEAM:** Shreyas Iyer (C), Abhishek Sharma, Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, Ishan Kishan (WK), Sanju Samson (WK), Tilak Varma (VC), Shivam Dube, Kuldeep Yadav, Axar Patel, Washington Sundar, Ravi Bishnoi, Nitish Kumar Reddy, Arshdeep Singh, Prince Yadav, Mayank Yadav.

**REST OF INDIA SQUAD:** Rishabh Pant [C, WK], Sanat Sangwan, Shikhar Mohan, Sudip Gharami, Sarfaraz Khan [VC], Smaran Ravichandran, Manav Suthar, Saransh Jain, Akash Deep\*, Mukesh Kumar, Mukesh Choudhary, Aryan Juyal [WK], Aryan Pandey, Anukul Roy, Ayush Doseja.

Case of Pandya and Pant

While Pandya is supposed to be declared fit on September 20, the national selection panel won't pick him if he doesn't prove that he is fit to bowl 10 overs for India A.

While a section in BCCI wanted Pandya to play against the West Indies directly since he could be cleared by the COE for his 'Return To Play' by September 20, the selection panel is clear that "not six overs but Pandya will only be included when he starts bowling full quota

of 10 overs." In case of Rishabh Pant, it is understood that selectors went by the feedback from the important members of the team management who feel that the maverick keeper-batter hasn't done justice to his phenomenal talent when it comes to white ball cricket. As reported by the PTI, Pant has been named captain of the Rest of India team for the Irani Cup with burly Mumbai batter Sarfaraz Khan as the vice-captain.

reserve middle-order batting all-rounder and extra pacer is concerned.

Dhir has played only 14 List A Games for Punjab in the Vijay Hazare Trophy scoring 357 runs at an average of 39, a strike-rate of 106 and four half-centuries to go with a top score of 97.

He has also taken 7 wickets with his part-time off-breaks.

Nabi, on his part, has 56 wickets from 36 List A games for Jammu and Kashmir and also bowls

Para Shooting World C'ship: Millie, Mona, Avani win team gold

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA  
New Delhi, September 16

Millie Shah, Mona Agarwal and Avani Lekhara combined to win gold medal in the R2 women's 10m air rifle standing SH1 team event at the Changwon 2026 WSPS Para Shooting World Championships in South Korea recently.

Rakesh Nidagundi, Anandha Krishna and Swaroop Unhalkar claimed silver in the R1 men's 10m air rifle standing SH1 team event.

They shot a combined total of 1856.3a across five series.

The Indian women's trio aggregated 1878.6 to win the top prize recently.

Mona and Avani also won a silver and bronze respectively in the R2 women's 10m air rifle standing SH1 event.

The performances added two medals to India's tally at the world championships, with the country making its mark in the rifle team events.

Chess Olympiad: Indian men beat Thailand 3-1

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA  
Samarkand, September 16

World champion D Gukesh, Nihal Sarin and Vidit Gujrathi registered convincing victories but Arjun Erigaisi's late collapse cost India a clean sweep as the men's team began its campaign at the 46th World Chess Olympiad with a 3-1 win over Thailand here on Wednesday.

Nihal was the first Indian to win, defeating Thanadon Kulpruethanon, before Gukesh produced a

brilliant attacking display to beat Faris Rashid Alriyami. Vidit then completed a comfortable victory over Tupfah Khumnorkaew.

Arjun, however, went down to Prin Laohawirapap after being in a position of strength for much of the game.

Playing with the white pieces, Arjun missed a huge advantage in the latter stages of the middle-game and was eventually dragged into the sixth hour.

Laohawirapap, a 20-year-old, held his nerve



despite running short of time and capitalised on Arjun's final blunder. With checkmate imminent, Arjun resigned.

Arjun was not the only big name to suffer on the opening day, with highly-rated Levon Aronian of the United States being held

to a draw by Iraq's Ali Ehsan Aryan. The Indian women's team, meanwhile, began its campaign with a commanding 4-0 victory over the Dominican Republic. Top-ranked Indian Koneru Humpy made a winning start with a victory over Franchesca Ramirez Luzon with the white pieces, while R Vaishali had a smooth outing against Miguelina De La Rosa Martinez.

Vantika Agrawal had to work harder for her victory over Mary Loly Gonzalez Peguero. The Indian

appeared to be heading towards a draw before an error by her opponent led to a rook-and-minor-piece endgame, in which Vantika's advanced passed pawn proved decisive.

B Savitha Shri also celebrated her Olympic debut with a win over Karla Mya Nunez Diaz.

'IPL auction to make India return'

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA  
New Delhi, September 16

The IPL players' auction for the 2027 season is set to be held in India with league chairman Arun Dhumal saying that he is keen to bring the event back home after holding it overseas for the past three years.

The past three editions of the auction were held in Dubai, Jeddah (mega auction) and Abu Dhabi.

"Every year we try for this to happen in India, but we don't get the venue given the heavy marriage season. So, we definitely want it to be here this year, given that it would be a smaller auction and hopefully we will get the venue," Dhumal, who is set to be re-elected as IPL chairman during the BCCI AGM on September 18, told PTI. The host city of the auction will be decided based on the availability of BCCI's preferred venue.

At a recent Governing Council meeting, the contentious Impact Player concept was also discussed after the BCCI asked the teams for fresh feedback on the rule that is supposed to be in place till 2027. Among the players who have expressed their reservations on the Impact Player rule are India ODI and Test captain Shubman Gill, former captain Rohit Sharma, Hardik Pandya and Axar Patel.

COURT NOTICE  
(U/O s Rule 20 CPC)  
IN THE COURT OF  
Sh. Tarun Chaudhary  
Civil Judge (Junior Division) Hansi  
Sunder Kumar s/o sh Shankar Dass  
R/o Bank colony Hansi  
Vs.  
Ritu wife of Sh Rajender Kumar son  
of sh Jai parkash R/o Radhey Shyam  
mandir wali Gali  
subhash Nagar Hansi  
Suit for symbolic possession by way  
of specific performance against the  
defendant no. 1 in respect of  
agreement to sell executed on  
19.09.2016 regarding land measuring  
1 marlas (301 square yards) being  
10/345, share of land measuring 17  
kanals 05 marlas comprising khatwa  
no. 778 khata no. 447/1/2/1 (4-2)  
448/5/2/1 (0-17) 5/2/2(1-19) 6/1(7-7)  
7/1/1(3-0) bounded as east danda 49  
feet property of others west danda 49  
feet rasta 20 feet wide north danda  
55 feet 4 inch property of def no. 1  
south danda 55 feet 4 inch property  
of other bearing MCH danda 55  
feet 4 inch property ID 3GRJ5FE5  
situated near V5 industries Radhika  
road bhatia colony Hansi Distt Hissar  
alongwith factory under the name  
of style of Radhey metal industry  
which was sold by def no. 1 on the  
basis of registered sale deed bearing  
vasika no. 6546 dated 16.01.2015  
which was above agreement was  
entered into between def no. 1 and  
the plaintiff for the sale of above  
said land for total sale consideration  
of Rs. 700000/- and the complete  
amount of sale consideration of rs  
700000/- has already been paid  
by the plaintiff to def no. 1 in the  
presence of witnesses and the actual  
land physical poss of the above said  
land was also handed over by her to  
the plaintiff for the spot and that the  
alleged transfer deed bearing vasika  
no. 1162 dated 11.05.2023, allegedly  
executed by def no. 1 in favour of def  
no. 2 qua the suit land is totally false  
frivolous wrong illegal against law  
against facts without competency  
without authority null and void  
abinitio waction based upon fraud  
and misrepresentation and has no  
binding effect upon the rights of the  
plaintiff and the same is liable to be set  
aside alongwith its resultant mutation  
if any. Oral as well as documentary  
evidence of all kinds.  
CNR No. HRHSAO-001243-2024  
Next Date:- 07-10-2026  
PUBLICATION ISSUED TO:  
Ritu  
Spouse: -Rajender Kumar S/o Jai  
Parkash  
Radhey Shyam Mandir Wali, Subhash  
Nagar Hansi, Teh. Hansi, Distt Hissar,  
Hansi, HISSAR, HARYANA  
In above titled case, the defendant (s)/  
respondent(s) could not be served. It is  
ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s)  
should appear in person or through  
counsel on 07.10.2026 at 10:00 am.  
For details login to <https://highcourtchd.gov.in/2mod> = district  
notice & district = Hissar  
Sd/- Sh. Tarun Chaudhary  
Civil Judge  
(Junior Division)  
Dated this day of 16.09.2026 Hansi

झारखण्ड सरकार, स्वास्थ्य, चिकित्सा शिक्षा एवं परिवार कल्याण विभाग

प्रेस विज्ञापित

राज्य के सरकारी चिकित्सा महाविद्यालयों के विभिन्न विभागों में शैक्षणिक संवर्ग के सह-प्राध्यापक के रिक्त पदों (बैकलॉग) पर संविदा के आधार पर सेवाएँ प्राप्त करने हेतु विज्ञापन।

स्वास्थ्य चिकित्सा शिक्षा एवं परिवार कल्याण विभाग, झारखण्ड के नियंत्रणाधीन शहीद निर्मल महतो चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय एवं अस्पताल, धनबाद, एम0जी0एम0 चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय एवं अस्पताल, जमशेदपुर, फुलों ज्ञानो चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय एवं अस्पताल, दुमका, मेदिनीराय चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय एवं अस्पताल, पलामू तथा शेख मिखारी चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय एवं अस्पताल, हजारीबाग के विभिन्न विभागों में विभागवार प्राध्यापक के रिक्त पदों (बैकलॉग) पर Walk-In-Interview के माध्यम से संविदा के आधार पर सेवाएँ प्राप्त करने हेतु आवेदन आमंत्रित किये जाते हैं।

विभागवार सह-प्राध्यापक पद की रिक्ति की विवरणी निम्नांकित है जो अधिक / कम हो सकती है:-

| क्र0सं0 | विभाग का नाम     | कुल रिक्ति | ST | SC | BC I | BC II |
|---------|------------------|------------|----|----|------|-------|
| 1       | माईकोयपोर्लोलीजी | 1          | 0  | 0  | 1    | 0     |
| 2       | फार्माकोलॉजी     | 1          | 0  | 0  | 1    | 0     |
| 3       | पी0एस0एम0        | 2          | 1  | 1  | 0    | 0     |
| 4       | नेत्र            | 1          | 0  | 1  | 0    | 0     |
| 5       | निष्चेतना        | 3          | 0  | 1  | 1    | 1     |
| 6       | मनोरोग           | 2          | 1  | 0  | 1    | 0     |
| 7       | दन्त             | 2          | 1  | 1  | 0    | 0     |
| Total   |                  | 12         | 3  | 4  | 4    | 1     |

अर्हता :- सह-प्राध्यापक के पद पर संविदा के आधार पर सेवाएँ प्राप्त करने हेतु एम0सी0आई / एन0एम0सी0 के द्वारा निर्धारित योग्यता एवं वांछित अनुभव लागू होगा।

चयन का आधार :- Walk-In-Interview के माध्यम से संविदा के आधार पर सेवाएँ प्राप्त करने हेतु गठित चयन समिति द्वारा विहित प्रक्रिया के अन्तर्गत तत्संबंधी अभिलेखों की जाँच की जायेगी। तदनुसार विभागवार रिक्ति के विरुद्ध चयनित अभ्यर्थियों के नाम की अनुशंसा की जायेगी।

नियुक्ति की शर्तें :-

a) सह-प्राध्यापक के पद पर संविदा के आधार पर सेवाएँ प्राप्त करने के लिए एम0सी0आई / एन0एम0सी0 के द्वारा निर्धारित योग्यता एवं वांछित अनुभव संबंधी प्राप्तावन लागू होंगे।

b) चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय के विभिन्न विभागों में सह-प्राध्यापक के पद पर संविदा के आधार पर पदधारकों को समय-समय पर वित्त विभाग द्वारा दिये गये परामर्श के अनुरूप मासिक मानदेय देय होगा। इसके अतिरिक्त अन्य कोई भत्ता / सुविधा देय नहीं होगा।

c) चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय के विभिन्न विभागों में सह-प्राध्यापक के पद पर संविदा आधारित सेवाएँ अधिकतम 02 वर्ष अथवा नियमित नियुक्ति / प्रोन्नति, जो पहले हो, तक अथवा 70 वर्ष की आयु तक होगी।

d) 02 वर्ष की संविदा अवधि की समाप्ति के उपरान्त उनके Performance का मूल्यांकन संतोषजनक पाये जाने पर आगामी वर्षों हेतु एक बार में एक वर्ष के लिए सेवा विस्तार वित्त विभाग की सहमति से किया जायेगा।

e) संविदा आधारित यह नियुक्ति पूर्णतः औपबंधिक होगी एवं संविदा के आधार पर सेवाएँ प्राप्त करने हेतु चयनित अभ्यर्थियों द्वारा मविष्य में नियमित नियुक्ति एवं अन्य सुविधाओं का दावा नहीं किया जायेगा।

f) अवकाश :- संविदा आधारित चिकित्सा शिक्षाओं को कैलेण्डर वर्ष के लिए राज्य कमियों के अनुरूप आकस्मिक अवकाश देय होगा, परन्तु अन्य किसी अवकाश के हकदार नहीं होंगे।

g) किसी चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय में संविदा पर नियुक्त सह-प्राध्यापक का स्थानांतरण किसी अन्य चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय एवं अस्पताल में नहीं किया जायेगा।

h) सभी चिकित्सा महाविद्यालयों में सह-प्राध्यापक के उतने ही पद इस व्यवस्था से भरे जायेंगे जितना नितान्त आवश्यक होगा। इन पदों पर सेवाएँ प्राप्त करने हेतु आकांक्ष प्रतिलिपि का अनुपालन किया जायेगा।

i) वित्त विभाग से प्राप्त परामर्श के आधार पर मंत्रिपरिषद द्वारा लिए गए निर्णय के अनुसार संविदा राशि निर्धारण के संबंध में विभागीय संकल्प-407 (9) दिनांक 02.09.2021 एवं विभागीय अधिसूचना 357 (9) दिनांक 30.07.2024 के आलोक में सह-प्राध्यापक के पद पर नियुक्त पद धारक को मानदेय 2,00,000/- (दो लाख रुपये) देय होगा इसके अतिरिक्त अन्य कोई भत्ता या सुविधा देय नहीं होगा।

अधिकतम उम्र सीमा :- संविदा आधारित चिकित्सा शिक्षाओं के लिए अधिकतम उम्र सीमा सभी वर्गों के लिए 70 वर्ष होगी।

रिक्त पदों पर वाक-इन-इंटरव्यू रिस्स, रॉची के प्रशासनिक भवन में निम्नांकित तिथियों में सम्पन्न होगा :-

| क्र0सं0 | पदनाम         | दिनांक     | समय      |
|---------|---------------|------------|----------|
| 01      | सह-प्राध्यापक | 21.09.2026 | 10:30 AM |

7. सभी इच्छुक उम्मीदवार वेबसाईट :- [www.jharkhand.gov.in/health](http://www.jharkhand.gov.in/health) के अन्तर्गत Recruitment पर दिये गये आवेदन पत्र में अंकित सभी वांछित सूचनाएँ पूर्णरूपेण भर कर, सभी मूल प्रमाण पत्रों की स्वअभिप्रमाणित छायाप्रति एवं मूल प्रमाण पत्रों के साथ वाक-इन-इंटरव्यू आयोजन की तिथि पर ससमय भाग लेंगे।

8. इस विज्ञापन को स्थगित करने, किसी आवेदन को बिना कोई कारण बताए स्वीकृत / अस्वीकृत करने एवं रिक्ति के अवशेष रहने की अवस्था में पुनः विज्ञापन प्रकाशित करने का सर्वाधिकार स्वास्थ्य चिकित्सा शिक्षा एवं परिवार कल्याण विभाग को सुरक्षित रहेगा।

निदेशक,  
चिकित्सा शिक्षा, झारखंड, रॉची

PR 389808 Health Med Edu and Family Welfare (26-27)\_D

भोपाल विकास प्राधिकरण, भोपाल

क्रमांक : 478/का.यं. 01/ई-निविदा/भोविप्रा/2026

भोपाल, दिनांक : 15.09.2026

ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

निविदा प्रपत्र में वर्णित पंजीयन एवं पात्रता संबंधी मानदंडों को पूर्ण करने वाले ठेकेदारों एवं प्रतिष्ठित फर्मों/कंपनियों से निम्नलिखित कार्यों हेतु ई-निविदा प्रक्रिया द्वारा प्रतियोगिता के आधार पर ऑनलाइन निविदाएँ आमंत्रित की जाती हैं :-

| क्र. सं. | पोर्टल क्रमांक   | कार्य का नाम                                                                                                                                                                     | अनुमानित लागत P.A.C. (रुपये) | असेसट मनी डिपोजिट ई.एम.डी. (रुपये) | निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य (पोर्टल फीस के अलावा) (रुपये)                      | कार्य पूर्ण करने हेतु निर्धारित समयावधि |
|----------|------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| 1.       | 2026 DTCP 536267 | Supplying and erection of 8 No's of multi circuit monopole complete for 132KV DCDS line of 132/33 KV EHT electrical substation at salaiya, Bhopal (Bhopal Development Authority) | 13,21,60,024/-               | 10,00,000/-                        | Rs. 35,400/- (portal fees & G.S.T. are payable in addition to this amount) | 06 Months                               |

1. निविदा संबंधित अन्य विस्तृत विवरण वेबसाइट पोर्टल <http://www.mptenders.gov.in> पर देखे जा सकते हैं।

2. निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य एवं पोर्टल फीस की राशि क्रेडिट कार्ड/डेबिट कार्ड/कैश कार्ड या इंटरनेट बैंकिंग सिस्टम के माध्यम से उल्लेखित वेबसाइट पर भुगतान कर निविदा प्रपत्र दिनांक 16.09.2026 को 10.30 बजे से दिनांक 08.10.2026 को 18.00 बजे तक क्रय किये जा सकते हैं। अन्य Key Dates संबंधित Bid Data Sheet में देखी जा सकती है।

3. निविदा से संबंधित कोई भी संशोधन समाचार पत्रों में प्रकाशित न करते हुए केवल उल्लेखित वेबसाइट पर ही सूचित किए जायेंगे।

4. अन्य संबंधित जानकारी अधोहस्ताक्षरकर्ता के कार्यालय से किसी भी कार्य दिवस व समय में प्राप्त की जा सकती है।

म.प्र. माध्यम/128095/2026

कार्यपालन यंत्री, संभाग क्र.-1

जिला परिषद कार्यालय, जामताड़ा  
Email id: [zilaparishad\\_jamtara@yahoo.com](mailto:zilaparishad_jamtara@yahoo.com)

अल्पकालीन ई0 निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना सं0-ZILA/PARISHAD/JAMTARA/08/2026-27

1. कार्य की विस्तृत विवरणी :-

| क्र0 | युप सं0 | कार्य का नाम                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | प्राकलित राशि  | अग्रघन की राशि                                                                           | परिमाण विपत्र का मूल्य | कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि |
|------|---------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|
| 1    |         | 2                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | 3              | 4                                                                                        | 5                      | 6                     |
| 1    | 46      | कुण्डलित प्रखण्ड के स्वीकृत बागदेहरी के स्थान पर बागदेहरी पंचायत अन्तर्गत नवाडीह में दाग संख्या-02/A, खाता संख्या-91 में P.H.C निर्माण।                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | 1,42,99,900.00 | 2,86,000.00                                                                              | 10,000.00              | 9 माह                 |
| 2    | 47      | फरोहपुर प्रखण्ड के घसनियाँ के अनामारी खाता संख्या-50, दाग संख्या-1303 में P.H.C निर्माण।                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | 1,42,99,900.00 | 2,86,000.00                                                                              | 10,000.00              | 9 माह                 |
| 3    | 48      | नाला प्रखण्ड के कुलडगाल पंचायत के सदा मौजा राख में धागा संख्या-26, खाता नं0-58, दाग संख्या-02/A में P.H.C निर्माण।                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | 1,42,99,900.00 | 2,86,000.00                                                                              | 10,000.00              | 9 माह                 |
| 2.   |         | वेबसाईट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | -/-            | दिनांक-25.09.2026                                                                        |                        |                       |
| 3.   |         | ई0-निविदा प्राप्ति की तिथि एवं समय                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | -/-            | दिनांक-07.10.2026 (अपराह्न 5:00 बजे)                                                     |                        |                       |
| 4.   |         | निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि केवल Online Mode द्वारा की स्वीकार्य होगी।                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                |                                                                                          |                        |                       |
| 5.   |         | निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि का ई0-भुगतान जिस खाता से किया जायेगा, उसी खाते में अग्रघन की राशि वापस होगी। अगर खाता को बंद कर दिया जाता है तो सारी जबाबदेही संबंधित निविदादाता की होगी।                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                |                                                                                          |                        |                       |
| 6.   |         | निविदा खोलने का स्थान                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | -/-            | e-Procurement Cell, कार्यालय अभिलेखा का कार्यालय ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमण्डल, जामताड़ा। |                        |                       |
| 7.   |         | निविदा खुलने की तिथि एवं समय                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | -/-            | दिनांक-08.10.2026 (अपराह्न 2:00 बजे)                                                     |                        |                       |
| 8.   |         | निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकारी का नाम एवं पता                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | -/-            | कार्यालय अभिलेखा, ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमण्डल, जामताड़ा।                                |                        |                       |
| 9.   |         | ई0-निविदा प्रकोष्ठ का दूरभाष संख्या                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | -/-            | 9431347401                                                                               |                        |                       |
| 10.  |         | अधोहस्ताक्षरों / सक्षम पदाधिकारी को किसी भी निविदा को बिना कारण बताये रद्द करने का अधिकार सुरक्षित रहेगा तथा निविदादाता को कारण प्रुछा का अधिकार मान्य नहीं होगा।                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                |                                                                                          |                        |                       |
| 11.  |         | B.O.Q की राशि घट-बढ़ सकती है, तदनुसार अग्रघन की राशि देय होगी।                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                |                                                                                          |                        |                       |
| 10   | (रस)    | प्रतिशत से अधिक न्यून निविदाओं के लिए पोलिगो के संकल्प सं0-2146 (एस) दिनांक 09.09.2020 के अनुसार Additional Performance Security के रूप में परिमाण विपत्र की राशि से-(i) 10% से 20% प्रतिशत below तक की राशि का 20% तथा (ii) 20% प्रतिशत से अधिक below तक की राशि का 30% राशि एकरारत्मा के समय जमा करना होगा। साथ ही साथ वर्णित संकल्प के अनुसार ही कार्य अर्बटन पर विचार किया जाएगा। केच एवं समान दर की निविदाओं के मामले में निविदा का निषादन पारदर्शी तरीके से लोटीरी की पद्धति द्वारा की जायेगी। |                |                                                                                          |                        |                       |
| 12.  |         | उप विकास आयुक्त-सह-मुख्य कार्यालय पदाधिकारी, जिला परिषद, जामताड़ा का पत्रांक-447 /विनिलिपि, दिनांक-03.09.2026 के क्रम में उक्त योजनाओं का कार्यान्वयन जिला परिषद, जामताड़ा द्वारा किया जाएगा।                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                |                                                                                          |                        |                       |
| 13.  |         | विस्तृत जानकारी के लिए वेबसाईट <a href="http://www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in">www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in</a> एवं कार्यालय के सूचना पट्ट पर देखा जा सकता है।                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                |                                                                                          |                        |                       |

ह0/-  
जिला अभियंता  
जिला परिषद, जामताड़ा

PR 389916 Rural Development(26-27)\_D



### AROUND THE WORLD

- » **IGNOU extends deadline for July 2026 fresh admissions to September 30**
- » **West Bengal to add Syama Prasad Mookerjee to school, college curricula from 2027**
- » **University Grants Commission invites nominations for Srinivasan Award in Physics**
- » **BITS Pilani hosts Japan career day under global South-Japan tech talent initiative**
- » **India Accounts for 1 in 3 large organizations among Asia's best workplaces 2026: Report**



### BUZZER ROUND

**Q) When did India qualify for the Fifa World Cup?**

Send us your replies to [careersmp22@gmail.com](mailto:careersmp22@gmail.com). We shall publish the names of the first 3 correct entries in next week's edition

Answer to our Sep 9 edition question: **July 20, 1969**

Correct answers were sent by: **Diptanshu Sinha, Reetika Kumar, Ibrahim Mondal**



### NEWS & VIEWS

In a significant development, no Indian business school has made it to the top 50 in the QS Global MBA Rankings 2027. IIM Bangalore emerged as the highest-ranked Indian institute at joint 64th position. IIM Ahmedabad followed at joint 70th, while IIM Calcutta secured 95th place.

According to Scholars at Risk, an international network that monitors attacks on higher education, academic freedom in India is "severely restricted". In its report, 'Free to Think 2026', the group said growing Central government authority over higher education influenced university governance, leadership appointments and academic priorities, while university administrators took steps that curbed campus discourse and student expression.

### STUDY ABROAD GETS COSTLIER

### PART II

# WEAK RUPEE WEIGHS ON OVERSEAS EDUCATION PLANS

*Currency depreciation is adding to the financial strain on Indian students already grappling with higher tuition and living costs*

ANINDITA ACHARYA

Tighter and uncertain visa rules, rising costs, increasing anti-immigrant rhetoric, housing discrimination and food-based prejudice are making Indian students' study-abroad dreams more challenging with each passing day. Adding to this ordeal is the weakening Indian rupee, which is hitting students studying abroad hard. Unfortunately, the rupee is Asia's worst-performing currency in 2026, having tumbled to a historic intraday low of 96.47 against the US dollar.

The rupee's decline compounds an existing concern rather than creating a new one, said Tripti Maheshwari, Co-Founder, Student Circus. According to her, when the rupee weakens, tuition, accommodation, living expenses and loan repayments against a foreign currency all rise together, adding pressure on top of the visa uncertainty and job-market risks that families are already navigating. "A weaker rupee also affects education loans directly: EMIs calculated against a foreign currency become costlier to service the longer the rupee stays under pressure, which changes how families plan repayment even before the student graduates," she said.

As reported earlier, the study-abroad dream is no longer driven only by students from metro cities in India. Studies show that an increasing number of students pursuing international education come from small towns, particularly Tier 2 and Tier 3 cities. This means not all Indian students chasing global education dreams come from affluent families. Many are

taking up odd jobs in addition to their part-time shifts to sustain themselves. In fact, reports suggest that several Indian students are skipping meals or surviving on just one meal a day to save money, a harsh reality amid the rupee's decline.

"The weakening rupee has become one of the more immediate pressure points this year. The rupee has depreciated by roughly 10 per cent or more against the US dollar over the past year, with similar movement against the pound and euro. For a family budgeting Rs 40-70 lakh for a full programme, this kind of currency movement alone can add anywhere from Rs 4-8 lakh a year in extra cost, even before accounting for tuition hikes or inflation in living expenses at the destination. The impact shows up most visibly in loan behaviour, many students who took loans a year or two ago, calculated at a stronger rupee, are now finding the sanctioned amount insufficient and are going back to their banks for top-ups. It has made currency planning, timing remittances, sometimes converting funds in advance, a much more active part of pre-departure planning than it used to be," said Lakshmi Iyer Chief Client Officer & Chairperson, StudyIn India.

The reality for most Indian families planning to send their children abroad for higher education is closely linked to savings. Parents save, while students often take loans to fuel the dream. The end goal is to study abroad and

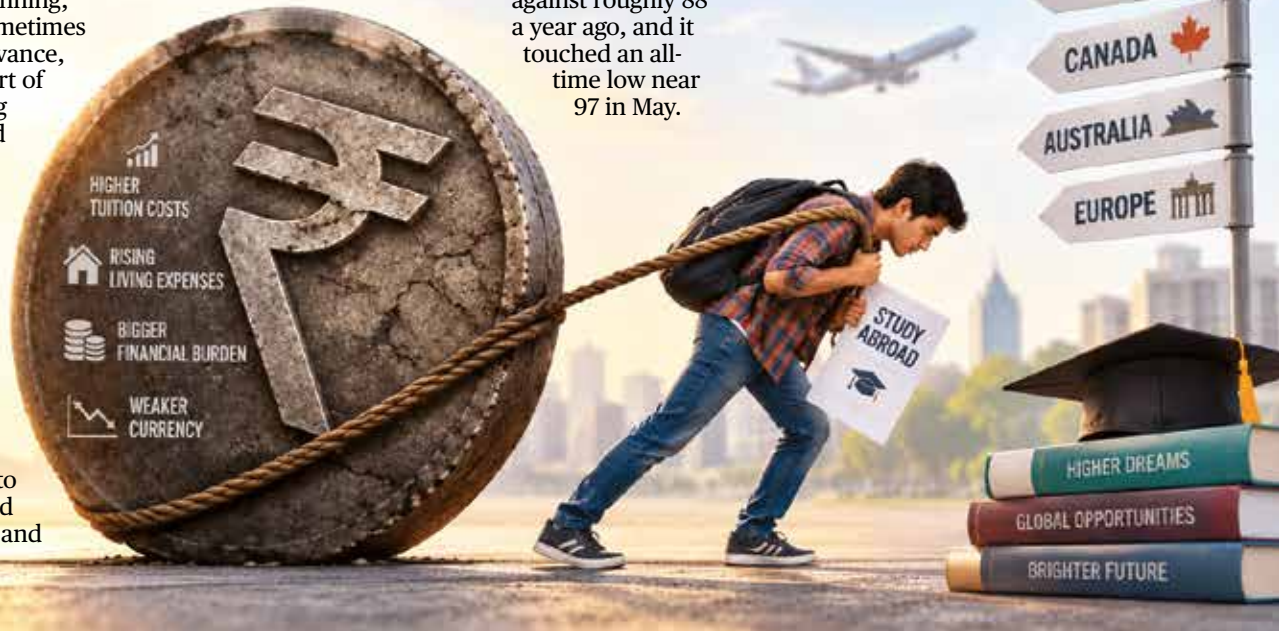
eventually settle overseas with a well-paying job. However, rising tuition costs and the falling rupee are increasingly becoming a burden for Indian families.

Today, many Indian students' lives abroad are being shaped by discounts and cost-cutting. They look for discounted groceries and food, making the study-abroad experience far removed from the international lifestyle that was once romanticised. "An Indian student today needs to show nearly Rs 4 lakh more in their bank account to cover flights and basic visa maintenance than they did two years ago. In the UK, the monthly maintenance requirement has risen from £1,023 to £1,171 over the same period. Flight tickets have also become more expensive, with students now paying around 20,000 more per ticket, roughly a 30% increase compared to two years earlier, with the rupee's depreciation accounting for a significant part of that increase. This is pushing more students toward alter-

natives either more affordable destinations where the cost gap is smaller, or International Branch Campuses in India that offer the same degree without the currency exposure at all. Affordability has always mattered in this decision. What has changed is that it is now weighed alongside employability and policy stability, not in isolation, and the rupee has simply added one more variable to that calculation," added Maheshwari.

A 2026 study mentioned that Indian student enrolments in the US, UK, Canada and Australia are forecast to decline by an average of 0.5% annually through 2030. In such a scenario, as Maheshwari pointed out, other affordable destinations such as Ireland, Italy and Germany are attracting Indian students due to their employment prospects, better post-study work permits and lower tuition fees.

"The rupee is trading close to 94.5 to the dollar in early September 2026, against roughly 88 a year ago, and it touched an all-time low near 97 in May.



## Maharashtra, Tamil Nadu top education job postings

*Education hiring up nearly 14% in one year*

### OUR CORRESPONDENT

Teaching roles fell to their lowest point in October 2025 before recovering steadily from January 2026 onward. By July 2026, postings had reached their strongest level in the 12-month period, marking nine consecutive months of growth. According to a latest study of Indeed, job postings across the sector increased by nearly 14% between July 2025 and July 2026. At the same time, contract and part-time teaching opportunities grew faster than traditional full-time roles. While full-time education-sector job postings increased by

**GERMAN TEACHING POSTINGS GREW 22.8% OVER THE YEAR. ENGLISH TEACHING POSTINGS INCREASED 20%, FOLLOWED BY HINDI AT 16.7% AND FRENCH AT 8.2%**

nearly 14% over the past year, contract roles grew by almost 40%. Part-time opportunities also increased by nearly 28%.

The faster growth of these roles could reflect employers' need for greater flexibility, particularly when hiring

professionals with specialised expertise or responding to specific and changing learning requirements.

For professionals, the shift could also create opportunities for different ways of working within the education sector.

However, education-sector hiring remains particularly strong across several major Indian states. As of July 2026, Maharashtra accounted for the largest share of education-sector job postings on Indeed at 14.3%, followed closely by Tamil Nadu at 14.2%. Karnataka accounted for 11.8% of postings, while Kerala represented 10%.



### Trending

### COURSES

## École Ducasse launches three new professional courses

### OUR CORRESPONDENT

As gastronomy continues to evolve towards more plant-forward, responsible and ingredient-led approaches, École Ducasse is expanding its professional training portfolio with three new intensive programmes launching in spring 2027.

The new Essentials of Naturalité programme at Paris campus will offer a four-week immersive experience dedicated to Alain Ducasse's culinary philosophy. The course is in English and will start from April 9, 2027.

Another course, Vegan Pastry Essentials will be delivered in English at École Nationale Supérieure de Pâtisserie (ENSP) from April 19, 2027. And the last, Les Essentiels de la Pâtisserie Végane will be delivered in French at ENSP from May 18, 2027.

Plant-based cuisine and pastry



are explored within existing Essentials programmes, including Naturalité: The Essentials in Culinary Arts Essentials and vegan pastry within French Pastry Arts Essentials, as well as through professional short courses such as Cuisine végétale, L'ADN de la Naturalité and Nadia Sammut's Cuisiner le vivant.

The launch of Essentials of Naturalité and Vegan Pastry Essentials offer dedicated four-week programmes that allow participants to deepen their technical and creative mastery of plant-based gastronomy.

### SCHOLARSHIP



## WOMEN IN ENGINEERING LEADERSHIP SCHOLARSHIP



*Application deadline ends on Jan 15, 2027*

### OUR CORRESPONDENT

Swinburne University of Technology has announced the Women in Engineering Leadership Scholarship for international students commencing engineering and construction courses in 2027 at its Hawthorn campus. Eligible students will receive a 30% reduction in tuition fees for the standard duration of their programme. The application deadline ends on January 15, 2027.

The scholarship is available for undergraduate and postgraduate programmes, including the Bachelor of Construction Management (Honours), Bachelor of Engineering (Honours), Master of Construction and Infrastructure Management, Master of Engineering Science and Master of Professional Engineering.

International students commencing an eligible course at Swinburne's Hawthorn campus for the first time in 2027 will be considered for the scholarship, subject to meeting the relevant eligibility criteria.

To apply for the scholarship, a candidate must be an international student and meet the relevant course and scholarship-specific entry requirements. The candidate must not be receiving a Swinburne tuition fee scholarship or any other reduced fee arrangement simultaneously. The candidate should not receive any other tuition fee scholarship or reduced fee arrangement from another organisation at the same time. Established in 1908, Swinburne University of Technology is a globally recognised university based in Melbourne, Australia, known for its strong focus on innovation, industry engagement, and future-ready education.

### HOW TO APPLY

Students applying to commence an eligible course for the first time in 2027 at Swinburne University of Technology's Hawthorn campus will be automatically considered for available international scholarships based on their previous academic performance. Successful applicants will receive a letter of offer confirming admission, which will also indicate if they have been awarded an international scholarship.

### BLACKBOARD

As manipulated videos and synthetic media become increasingly difficult to distinguish from authentic content, students from the Department of Computer Science & Engineering at East Point College of Engineering & Technology (EPCET), Bengaluru, have developed a web-based AI-powered deepfake video detection system designed to help identify whether a video has been manipulated.

NIT Rourkela celebrated its 24th Convocation with a graduating class of 2033 students (508 female & 1525 male) recently. Prof Abhay Karandikar, Member, NITI Aayog, graced the occasion as the chief guest, and Prof Bidyadhar Subudhi, Director, NIT Warangal, attended the ceremony as the guest of honour.

IIT Guwahati researchers have developed an eco-friendly biological approach to treat textile wastewater containing toxic azo dyes. The research provides a scientific foundation to develop biological treatment systems for textile wastewater containing azo dyes. The approach could offer an eco-friendly alternative or complementary treatment to conventional chemical and physicochemical methods.